

Euthyphro

ΕΥΘΥΦΡΩΝ

Plato

translated by David Horan

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2a

E: What ever is going on, Socrates? You have left your usual haunt in the Lyceum¹ and you are now spending time here at the Royal Stoa.² Surely you too do not have a suit before the Royal Archon, as I do.

2a

S: Well, Athenians, Euthyphro, do not call it a suit, but a prosecution.

ΕΥΘ. τί νεώτερον, ὦ Σώκρατες, γέγονεν, ὅτι σὺ τὰς ἐν Λυκείῳ καταλιπὼν διατριβὰς ἐνθάδε νῦν διατρίβεις περὶ τὴν τοῦ βασιλέως στοάν; οὐ γάρ που καὶ σοί γε δίκη τις οὔσα τυγχάνει πρὸς τὸν βασιλέα ὥσπερ ἐμοί. ΣΩ. οὔτοι δὴ Ἀθηναῖοί γε, ὦ Εὐθύφρων, δίκην αὐτὴν καλοῦσιν ἀλλὰ γραφὴν.

2b

E: What are you saying? Then someone is prosecuting you it seems, for I shall not accuse you of prosecuting someone else.

2b

S: Of course not.

2b

E: Is someone prosecuting you then?

2b

S: Yes, indeed.

2b

E: Who is he?

2b

S: I hardly even know the man myself, Euthyphro. Apparently he is someone young and unknown. Anyway, his name, I believe, is Meletus. He belongs to the deme³ of Pittheus, if you can think of a Meletus from Pittheus with straight hair, not much of a beard, and a hook nose.

2b

E: I cannot think of anyone, Socrates. But tell me, what charge has he brought against you?

ΕΥΘ. τί φής; γραφήν σέ τις, ὡς ἔοικε, γέγραπται· οὐ γὰρ ἐκεῖνό γε καταγνώσομαι, ὡς σὺ ἕτερον. ΣΩ. οὐ γὰρ οὖν. ΕΥΘ. ἀλλὰ σὲ ἄλλος; ΣΩ. πάνυ γε. ΕΥΘ. τίς οὗτος; ΣΩ. οὐδ' αὐτὸς πάνυ τι γινώσκω, ὧ Εὐθύφρων, τὸν ἄνδρα, νέος γάρ τις μοι φαίνεται καὶ ἀγνῶς· ὀνομάζουσι μέντοι αὐτόν, ὡς ἐγὼμαι, Μέλητον. ἔστι δὲ τῶν δῆμων Πιτθεύς, εἴ τινα νῶ ἔχεις Πιτθέα Μέλητον οἶον τετανότριχα καὶ οὐ πάνυ εὐγένειον, ἐπίγρυπον δέ. ΕΥΘ. οὐκ ἐννοῶ, ὧ Σώκρατες· ἀλλὰ δὴ τίνα γραφήν

2c

S: What charge? Well, it is no ordinary charge, in my opinion anyway. Indeed, it is quite an achievement for a young man to have understood a matter of such importance. For this fellow claims to know how the young people are being corrupted and who their corrupters are. And he is probably wise, and having discerned my ignorance he goes to the city, just as a child runs to its mother, accusing me of corrupting people of his own age. And it looks to me as if he alone embarks upon his political career in the right way, for it is right to care for the young people first so that they turn out as good as they possibly can, just as a good farmer is likely to care first for the young plants, and after that for the others. And in fact, Meletus is probably clearing us out first, the destroyers of the crop of youth, as he says. Then, of course, once he has cared for the older generation as well, he will be responsible for great benefits aplenty to our city. At least, that would be the likely outcome of setting about it in this way.

σε γέγραπται; ΣΩ. ἦντινα; οὐκ ἀγεννῆ, ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ· τὸ γὰρ νέον ὄντα τοσοῦτον πρᾶγμα ἐγνωκέναι οὐ φαῦλόν ἐστιν. ἐκεῖνος γάρ, ὡς φησιν, οἶδε τίνα τρόπον οἱ νέοι διαφθείρονται καὶ τίνες οἱ διαφθείροντες αὐτούς. καὶ κινδυνεύει σοφός τις εἶναι, καὶ τὴν ἐμὴν ἀμαθίαν κατιδὼν ὡς διαφθείροντος τοὺς ἡλικιώτας αὐτοῦ, ἔρχεται κατηγορήσων μου ὥσπερ πρὸς μητέρα πρὸς τὴν πόλιν. καὶ φαίνεται μοι τῶν πολιτικῶν μόνος ἄρχεσθαι ὀρθῶς· ὀρθῶς γάρ ἐστι τῶν νέων πρῶτον ἐπιμεληθῆναι ὅπως ἔσσονται ὅτι ἄριστοι, ὥσπερ γεωργὸν ἀγαθὸν τῶν

νέων φυτῶν εἰκὸς πρῶτον ἐπιμεληθῆναι, μετὰ δὲ τοῦτο καὶ τῶν ἄλλων. ΣΩ. καὶ δὴ καὶ Μέλητος ἴσως πρῶτον

3a

E: Would that it were so, Socrates, but I fear that the outcome may turn out to be the very opposite. In fact, I think he is actually starting off by damaging the very heart of our city by attacking you unjustly. But tell me, how exactly does he say you corrupt the young?

μὲν ἡμᾶς ἐκκαθαίρει τοὺς τῶν νέων τὰς βλάστας διαφθείροντας, ὥς φησιν· ἔπειτα μετὰ τοῦτο δηλον ὅτι τῶν πρεσβυτέρων ἐπιμεληθεὶς πλείστων καὶ μεγίστων ἀγαθῶν αἴτιος τῇ πόλει γενήσεται, ὥς γε τὸ εἰκὸς συμβῆναι ἐκ τοιαύτης ἀρχῆς ἀρξαμένῳ. ΕΥΘ. βουλοίμην ἄν, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἀλλ' ὁρρωδῶ μὴ τούναντίον γένηται· ἀτεχνῶς γάρ μοι δοκεῖ ἀφ' ἐστίας ἄρχεσθαι κακουργεῖν τὴν πόλιν, ἐπιχειρῶν ἀδικεῖν σέ. καὶ μοι λέγε, τί καὶ ποιοῦντά σέ φησι διαφθεῖρειν τοὺς νέους;

3b

S: It sounds absurd, my wonderful friend, on first hearing at any rate. For he says that I am an inventor of gods, and on the grounds that I am inventing new gods and disregarding the old ones, he is prosecuting me on their behalf, so he says.

3b

E: I understand, Socrates. It's because you say that the divine sign comes to you from time to time. So he has prosecuted you on this charge, as an innovator in matters divine, and he goes into court to slander you, knowing that such issues are easily misrepresented to most people. Indeed, in my own case too, whenever I say anything in the Assembly about matters divine, predicting the future for them, they laugh at me as if I were a madman, and yet nothing I foretold has not come true. But nevertheless, they are jealous of everyone like us. However, we must not worry about them, but face up to them.

ΣΩ. ἄτοπα, ὦ θαυμάσιε, ὥς οὕτω γ' ἀκοῦσαι. φησὶ γάρ με ποιητὴν εἶναι θεῶν, καὶ ὥς καινοῦς ποιοῦντα θεοὺς τοὺς δ' ἀρχαίους οὐ νομίζοντα ἐγράψατο τούτων αὐτῶν ἕνεκα, ὥς φησιν. ΕΥΘ. μανθάνω, ὦ Σώκρατες·

ὅτι δὴ σὺ τὸ δαιμόνιον φῆς σαυτῷ ἐκάστοτε γίγνεσθαι. ὥς οὖν καινοτομοῦντός σου περὶ τὰ θεῖα γέγραπται ταύτην τὴν γραφήν, καὶ ὥς διαβαλῶν δὴ ἔρχεται εἰς τὸ δικαστήριον, εἰδὼς ὅτι εὐδιάβολα τὰ τοιαῦτα πρὸς τοὺς πολλούς. καὶ ἐμοῦ γάρ τοι,

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S: Dear Euthyphro, being laughed at is perhaps not an issue. Indeed, the Athenians, in my view, are not greatly concerned if they believe that someone is clever, provided of course he does not set about teaching his own wisdom. But if they believe he is also making other people turn out like himself, they get angry, either out of jealousy, as you say, or for some other reason.

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E: Well, I am not very keen to test their precise attitude to me on this issue.

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S: Well, perhaps you have a reputation for holding yourself aloof and being reluctant to teach your own wisdom, while I am afraid lest, due to my love of humanity, I have a reputation in their eyes for saying whatever I have to say without restraint to anyone I meet, free of charge, and not only that, but I would gladly pay someone who was prepared to listen to me. Well, as I was saying just now, if they are going to laugh at me just as you say they laugh at you, it might be quite pleasant to spend our time having fun and laughing in the courtroom. But if, on the other hand, they are going to be serious, then it is unclear how the issue will turn out, except to soothsayers like yourself.

ὅταν τι λέγω ἐν τῇ ἐκκλησίᾳ περὶ τῶν θείων, προλέγων αὐτοῖς τὰ μέλλοντα, καταγελῶσιν ὥς μαινομένου· καίτοι οὐδὲν ὅτι οὐκ ἀληθὲς εἴρηκα ὧν προεῖπον, ἀλλ' ὅμως φθονοῦσιν ἡμῖν πᾶσι τοῖς τοιούτοις. ἀλλ' οὐδὲν αὐτῶν χρή φροντίζειν, ἀλλ' ὁμόσε ἰέναι. ΣΩ. ὦ φίλε Εὐθύφρων, ἀλλὰ τὸ μὲν καταγελασθῆναι ἴσως οὐδὲν πρᾶγμα. Ἀθηναίοις γάρ τοι, ὥς ἐμοὶ δοκεῖ, οὐ σφόδρα μέλει ἂν τινα δεινὸν οἶωνται εἶναι, μὴ μέντοι διδασκαλικὸν τῆς αὐτοῦ σοφίας· ὃν δ' ἂν καὶ ἄλλους οἶωνται

3d

E: Well, Socrates, perhaps it will all come to nothing. You will contest your suit in the way you see fit, and I think I shall do the same with mine.

ποιεῖν τοιούτους, θυμοῦνται, εἴτ' οὖν φθόνῳ ὥς σὺ λέγεις, εἴτε δι' ἄλλο τι. ΕΥΘ. τούτου οὖν πέρι ὅπως ποτὲ πρὸς ἐμὲ ἔχουσιν, οὐ πάνυ ἐπιθυμῶ πειραθῆναι. ΣΩ. ἴσως γὰρ σὺ μὲν δοκεῖς σπάνιον σεαυτὸν παρέχειν καὶ διδάσκειν οὐκ ἐθέλειν τὴν σεαυτοῦ σοφίαν· ἐγὼ δὲ φοβοῦμαι μὴ ὑπὸ φιλανθρωπίας δοκῶ αὐτοῖς ὅτιπερ ἔχω ἐκκεχυμένως παντὶ ἀνδρὶ λέγειν, οὐ μόνον ἄνευ μισθοῦ, ἀλλὰ καὶ προστιθεὶς ἂν ἡδέως εἴ τις μου ἐθέλει ἀκούειν. εἰ μὲν οὖν, ὃ νυνδὴ ἔλεγον, μέλλοιέν μου καταγελαῶν ὥσπερ

3e

S: But, Euthyphro, what is this suit of yours? Are you defending or prosecuting?

3e

E: I am prosecuting.

3e

S: Whom?

3e

E: Someone whom I am regarded as mad, once more, for prosecuting.

3e

S: Why so? Are you prosecuting someone who can fly?

3e

E: He is very far indeed from flying. In fact, he happens to be well on in years.

3e

S: Who is the man?

3e

E: My father.

σὺ φῆς σαυτοῦ, οὐδὲν ἂν εἴη ἀηδὲς παίζοντας καὶ γελῶντας ἐν τῷ δικαστηρίῳ διαγαγεῖν· εἰ δὲ σπουδάσονται, τοῦτ' ἤδη ὅπῃ ἀποβήσεται

ἄδηλον πλὴν ὑμῖν τοῖς μάντεσιν. ΕΥΘ. ἀλλ' ἴσως οὐδὲν ἔσται, ὦ Σώκρατες, πρᾶγμα, ἀλλὰ σύ τε κατὰ νοῦν ἀγωνιῇ τὴν δίκην, οἶμαι δὲ καὶ ἐμὲ τὴν ἐμήν. ΣΩ. ἔστιν δὲ δὴ σοί, ὦ Εὐθύφρων, τίς ἡ δίκη; φεύγεις αὐτὴν ἢ διώκεις; ΕΥΘ. διώκω. ΣΩ. τίνα;

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S: Your father, my good man?

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E: Yes, certainly.

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S: But what is the charge? And what is your suit about?

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E: Murder, Socrates.

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S: By Heracles, Euthyphro! Most people are presumably unaware of the proper procedure here. For I do not believe it is appropriate for any random person to do this, but only someone who is presumably already far advanced in wisdom.

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E: Far advanced indeed, by Zeus, Socrates.

4a

S: And was it some member of your family who was killed by your father? Of course it was, for I presume you would not have prosecuted your father for murder on account of a stranger.

ΕΥΘ. ὃν διώκων αὖ δοκῶ μαίνεσθαι. ΣΩ. τί δέ; πετόμενόν τινα διώκεις; ΕΥΘ. πολλοῦ γε δεῖ πέτεσθαι, ὅς γε τυγχάνει ὢν εὖ μάλα πρεσβύτης. ΣΩ. τίς οὗτος; ΕΥΘ. ὁ ἐμὸς πατήρ. ΣΩ. ὁ σός, ὦ βέλτιστε; ΕΥΘ. πάνυ μὲν οὔν. ΣΩ. ἔστιν δὲ τί τὸ ἔγκλημα καὶ τίνος ἡ δίκη; ΕΥΘ. φόνου, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. Ἡράκλεις, ἥ που, ὦ Εὐθύφρων, ἀγνοεῖται ὑπὸ τῶν πολλῶν ὅπη ποτὲ ὀρθῶς ἔχει· οὐ γὰρ οἶμαί γε τοῦ ἐπιτυχόντος

4b

E: It's amusing, Socrates, that you think it makes any difference whether the murdered man was a stranger or a family member, instead

of attending to the single issue of whether the killer killed his victim justly or unjustly. And if he acted justly, one should leave him be. However, if he acted unjustly, one should prosecute him, especially if the killer shares your hearth and your table. For equal is the pollution that befalls you if you live with such a person, knowing what he knows, without purifying yourself and that person by bringing him to justice. In this case, the man who was slain was a day-labourer of mine, and when we were farming on Naxos he worked on our land. One day, mad with wine, he got angry with one of our slaves and slit his throat. So my father bound him hand and foot, threw him into a ditch, and sent a man here to Athens to find out from the legal expositor what he should do. Meanwhile, he showed no regard for the man he had tied up and neglected him, since he was a murderer, and it did not matter even if he should die, which is exactly what happened to him. Before the messenger arrived back from the legal expositor, the man died from hunger, the cold, and his bonds.

Well, my father and the rest of my family are obviously angry over this, because I am prosecuting my father for murder on behalf of the murderer. They maintain that he did not actually kill the man, and even if he did definitely kill him the slain man was a murderer anyway, and I should not be concerned over someone like this, because it is unholy for a son to prosecute his father for murder. So poor is their knowledge of the divine realm, Socrates, and where it stands in relation to what is holy and what is unholy!

ὁρθῶς αὐτὸ πρᾶξαι ἀλλὰ πόρρω που ἤδη σοφίας ἐλαύνοντος. ΕΥΘ. πόρρω μέντοι νῆ Δία, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. ἔστιν δὲ δὴ τῶν οἰκείων τις ὁ τεθνεὺς ὑπὸ τοῦ σοῦ πατρὸς; ἢ δῆλα δῆ; οὐ γὰρ ἄν που ὑπὲρ γε ἀλλοτρίου ἐπεξῆσθα φόνου αὐτῷ. ΕΥΘ. γελοῖον, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὅτι οἶει τι διαφέρειν εἴτε ἀλλότριος εἴτε οἰκεῖος ὁ τεθνεὺς, ἀλλ' οὐ τοῦτο μόνον δεῖν φυλάττειν, εἴτε ἐν δίκῃ ἔκτεινεν ὁ κτείνας εἴτε μή, καὶ εἰ μὲν ἐν δίκῃ, ἔάν, εἰ δὲ μή, ἐπεξίεναι, ἐάνπερ ὁ κτείνας συνέστιός σοι καὶ ὁμοτράπεζος ἢ ἴσον γὰρ τὸ μίasma γίγνεται ἐὰν συνῆς τῷ τοιούτῳ

συνειδώς καὶ μὴ ἀφοσιοῖς σεαυτόν τε καὶ ἐκείνον τῇ δίκῃ ἐπεξιῶν. ἐπεὶ ὁ γε ἀποθανὼν πελάτης τις ἦν ἐμός, καὶ ὡς ἐγεωργοῦμεν ἐν τῇ Νάξῳ, ἐθήτευσεν ἐκεῖ παρ' ἡμῖν. παροινήσας οὖν καὶ ὀργισθεὶς τῶν οἰκετῶν τινι τῶν ἡμετέρων ἀποσφάττει αὐτόν. ὁ οὖν πατήρ συνδήσας τοὺς πόδας καὶ τὰς χεῖρας αὐτοῦ, καταβαλὼν εἰς τάφρον τινά, πέμπει δεῦρο ἄνδρα πεισόμενον τοῦ ἐξηγητοῦ ὅτι χρεῖη ποιεῖν. ἐν δὲ τούτῳ τῷ χρόνῳ τοῦ δεδεμένου ὠλιγώρει τε καὶ ἡμέλει ὡς ἀνδροφόνου καὶ οὐδὲν ὄν πρᾶγμα εἰ καὶ ἀποθάνοι, ὅπερ οὖν καὶ ἔπαθεν· ὑπὸ γὰρ λιμοῦ καὶ ῥίγους καὶ τῶν δεσμῶν ἀποθνήσκει πρὶν τὸν ἄγγελον παρὰ τοῦ ἐξηγητοῦ ἀφικέσθαι. ταῦτα δὴ οὖν καὶ ἀγανακτεῖ ὃ τε πατήρ καὶ οἱ ἄλλοι οἰκεῖοι, ὅτι ἐγὼ ὑπὲρ τοῦ ἀνδροφόνου τῷ πατρὶ φόνου ἐπεξέρχομαι οὔτε ἀποκτείναντι, ὡς φασιν ἐκεῖνοι, οὔτ' εἰ ὅτι μάλιστα ἀπέκτεινεν, ἀνδροφόνου γε ὄντος τοῦ ἀποθανόντος, οὐ δεῖν φροντίζειν ὑπὲρ τοῦ τοιούτου—ἀνόσιον

4e

S: But, by Zeus, Euthyphro, do you believe that you understand divine matters in relation to holiness and unholiness so precisely that you are not afraid, given the circumstances you are describing, of performing a further unholy action yourself by bringing your father to justice?

γὰρ εἶναι τὸ ὑὸν πατρὶ φόνου ἐπεξιέναι—κακῶς εἰδότες, ᾧ Σώκρατες, τὸ θεῖον ὡς ἔχει τοῦ ὁσίου τε πέρι καὶ τοῦ ἀνοσίου. ΣΩ. σὺ δὲ δὴ πρὸς Διός, ᾧ Εὐθύφρων, οὕτως ἀκριβῶς οἶε ἐπίστασθαι περὶ τῶν θείων ὅπη ἔχει, καὶ τῶν ὁσίων τε καὶ ἀνοσίων, ὥστε τούτων οὕτω πραχθέντων ὡς σὺ λέγεις, οὐ φοβῇ δικαζόμενος τῷ πατρὶ ὅπως μὴ αὖ σὺ ἀνόσιον πρᾶγμα τυγχάνης πράττων; ΕΥΘ. οὐδὲν γὰρ ἂν μου ὄφελος εἴη, ᾧ Σώκρατες, οὐδέ

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E: Socrates, I would be useless indeed, and Euthyphro would not be different from anybody else, if I did not have precise knowledge of all such matters.

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S: In that case, wonderful Euthyphro, my best course of action is to become your pupil and challenge Meletus on these very issues in

advance of his prosecution. I will do so by saying that, heretofore, I have always attached great importance to knowledge of divine matters, and now, since the man claims that I am falling into error through my rash utterances and innovations on matters divine, I have become your pupil. I would then say, “Dear Meletus, if you accept that Euthyphro is wise in such matters, then you should also believe that my views too are sound and drop the charge. Otherwise, rather than prosecuting me, prosecute Euthyphro, my teacher, for corrupting his elders, myself and his own father, by instructing me and censuring and punishing him.” And if I did not convince him, and he did not drop the charge, or prosecute you instead of me, I would say the very same things in court as in my pre-trial challenge.

τῷ ἂν διαφέροι Εὐθύφρων τῶν πολλῶν ἀνθρώπων, εἰ μὴ τὰ τοιαῦτα πάντα ἀκριβῶς εἰδείην. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν μοι, ὦ θαυμάσιε Εὐθύφρων, κράτιστόν ἐστι μαθητῇ σὺ γενέσθαι, καὶ πρὸ τῆς γραφῆς τῆς πρὸς Μέλητον αὐτὰ ταῦτα προκαλεῖσθαι αὐτόν, λέγοντα ὅτι ἔγωγε καὶ ἐν τῷ ἔμπροσθεν χρόνῳ τὰ θεῖα περὶ πολλοῦ ἐποιούμην εἰδέναι, καὶ νῦν ἐπειδὴ με ἐκεῖνος αὐτοσχεδιάζοντά φησι καὶ καινοτομοῦντα περὶ τῶν θείων ἔξαμαρτάνειν, μαθητῆς δὴ γέγονα σός — καὶ εἰ μὲν, ὦ Μέλητε, φαίην ἂν, Εὐθύφρονα ὁμολογεῖς σοφὸν εἶναι τὰ τοιαῦτα, καὶ ὀρθῶς νομίζειν καὶ ἐμὲ ἡγοῦ καὶ μὴ δικάζου· εἰ δὲ μή, ἐκείνῳ τῷ διδασκάλῳ λάχε δίκην πρότερον ἢ ἐμοί, ὥς τοὺς πρεσβυτέρους διαφθείροντι ἐμέ τε καὶ τὸν αὐτοῦ πατέρα, ἐμὲ μὲν διδάσκοντι, ἐκείνον δὲ νοθετοῦντί τε καὶ κολάζοντι — καὶ ἂν μὴ μοι πείθεται μηδὲ ἀφίη τῆς δίκης ἢ ἀντ' ἐμοῦ γράφηται σέ, αὐτὰ ταῦτα λέγειν ἐν τῷ δικαστηρίῳ ἃ προυκαλούμην αὐτόν; ΕΥΘ. ναὶ μὰ Δία, ὦ Σώκρατες, εἰ ἄρα ἐμὲ ἐπιχειρήσειε

5c

E: Yes, by Zeus, Socrates! And if he were to attempt to prosecute me, I think I would find where his weak point lies, and our argument in court would be concerned with him long before it concerned me.

5c

S: Yes, my dear friend, and I am eager to become your pupil because I recognise all this. I know that neither this man Meletus, nor anyone else I presume, seems even to notice you, yet he picked me out immediately, with so little difficulty that he has prosecuted me for impiety. Now then, tell me, by Zeus, what you claimed a moment ago to know full well. What sort of thing, according to you, is pious, and what is impious, in relation to murder or in relation to anything else? Is not the holy itself the same as itself, while the unholy is, in turn, the opposite of everything holy, yet like itself? In other words, anything that is to be unholy possesses a single form based upon unholiness?

γράφεσθαι, εὐροίμ' ἄν, ὡς οἶμαι, ὅπη σαθρός ἐστίν, καὶ πολὺ ἂν ἡμῖν πρότερον περὶ ἐκείνου λόγος ἐγένετο ἐν τῷ δικαστηρίῳ ἢ περὶ ἐμοῦ. ΣΩ. καὶ ἐγὼ τοι, ὦ φίλε ἐταῖρε, ταῦτα γιγνώσκων μαθητὴς ἐπιθυμῶ γενέσθαι σός, εἰδὼς ὅτι καὶ ἄλλος πού τις καὶ ὁ Μέλητος οὗτος σὲ μὲν οὐδὲ δοκεῖ ὀρᾶν, ἐμὲ δὲ οὕτως ὀξέως ἀτεχνῶς καὶ ῥαδίως κατεῖδεν ὥστε ἀσεβείας ἐγράψατο. νῦν οὖν πρὸς Διὸς λέγε μοι ὃ νυνδὴ σαφῶς εἰδέναι δισχυρίζου, ποῖόν τι τὸ εὐσεβὲς φῆς εἶναι καὶ τὸ ἀσεβὲς

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E: Of course, Socrates, entirely so.

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S: Tell me then, according to you, what is holiness and what is unholiness?

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E: Well, I say that what is holy is exactly what I am doing now, prosecuting the wrongdoer for murder, for robbing temples, or for committing any other crimes of that sort, even if he happens to be your father or mother or anyone else, while failure to prosecute is unholy. Now, Socrates, behold what convincing evidence I shall present of the law that this is the case, evidence I have already given to others, showing that these events are unfolding as they should, and we should not give way to an impious person no matter who that person happens to be. For people regard Zeus as the best and most just of the gods, and they accept that he bound his own father, Cronus, for

unjustly devouring his children, and that he, Cronus, in turn, had castrated his own father for similar reasons. Yet they are angry with me for prosecuting my father for acting unjustly, and so when speaking about the gods and when speaking about me, they are contradicting themselves.

καὶ περὶ φόνου καὶ περὶ τῶν ἄλλων; ἢ οὐ ταυτόν ἐστιν ἐν πάσῃ πράξει τὸ ὅσιον αὐτὸ αὐτῷ, καὶ τὸ ἀνόσιον αὐτὸ τοῦ μὲν ὁσίου παντὸς ἐναντίον, αὐτὸ δὲ αὐτῷ ὅμοιον καὶ ἔχον μίαν τινὰ ἰδέαν κατὰ τὴν ἀνοσιότητα πᾶν ὅτιπερ ἂν μέλλῃ ἀνόσιον εἶναι; ΕΥΘ. πάντως δήπου, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. λέγε δή, τί φῆς εἶναι τὸ ὅσιον καὶ τί τὸ ἀνόσιον; ΕΥΘ. λέγω τοίνυν ὅτι τὸ μὲν ὅσιον ἐστιν ὅπερ ἐγὼ νῦν ποιῶ, τῷ ἀδικοῦντι ἢ περὶ φόνους ἢ περὶ ἱερῶν κλοπᾶς ἢ τι ἄλλο τῶν τοιούτων ἐξαμαρτάνοντι ἐπεξίεναι, ἕαντε πατὴρ ὦν τυγχάνῃ ἕαντε μήτηρ ἕαντε ἄλλος ὅστισοῦν, τὸ δὲ μὴ ἐπεξίεναι ἀνόσιον· ἐπεὶ, ὦ Σώκρατες, θέασαι ὡς μέγα σοι ἐρῶ τεκμήριον τοῦ νόμου ὅτι οὕτως ἔχει—ὃ καὶ ἄλλοις ἤδη εἶπον, ὅτι ταῦτα ὀρθῶς ἂν εἴῃ οὕτω γιγνόμενα—μὴ ἐπιτρέπειν τῷ ἀσεβοῦντι μὴδ' ἂν ὅστισοῦν τυγχάνῃ ὦν. αὐτοὶ γὰρ οἱ ἄνθρωποι τυγχάνουσι νομίζοντες τὸν Δία τῶν θεῶν ἄριστον καὶ δικαιοτάτον,

6a

S: Well, Euthyphro, could this be the reason I am being prosecuted, because whenever someone tells me stories of this kind about the gods, I accept them only with some reluctance? Because of this, it seems, someone may well declare that I am in error. So now, if you who understand such matters so well also approve of these stories, then it seems that I need to go along with them too. For what else can someone say when they admit that they know nothing about these matters? But tell me, in the name of friendship, do you believe in truth that these things happened in this way?

καὶ τοῦτον ὁμολογοῦσι τὸν αὐτοῦ πατέρα δῆσαι ὅτι τοὺς ὑεῖς κατέπινεν οὐκ ἐν δίκῃ, κάκεινόν γε αὖ τὸν αὐτοῦ πατέρα ἐκτεμεῖν δι' ἕτερα τοιαῦτα· ἐμοὶ δὲ χαλεπαίνουσιν ὅτι τῷ πατρὶ ἐπεξέρχομαι ἀδικοῦντι, καὶ οὕτως αὐτοὶ αὐτοῖς τὰ ἐναντία λέγουσι περὶ τε τῶν θεῶν καὶ περὶ

έμοῦ. ΣΩ. ἄρά γε, ὦ Εὐθύφρων, τοῦτ' ἔστιν οὐ οὐνεκα τὴν γραφὴν φεύγω, ὅτι τὰ τοιαῦτα ἐπειδάν τις περὶ τῶν θεῶν λέγῃ, δυσχερῶς πως ἀποδέχομαι; διὸ δὴ, ὡς ἔοικε, φήσῃ τίς με ἐξαμαρτάνειν. νῦν οὖν εἰ καὶ σοὶ ταῦτα συνδοκεῖ τῷ

6b

E: Yes Socrates, and there are stories, even stranger than these, that most people do not know about.

6b

S: So, do you also believe that there really is war between the gods, bitter enmities, battles, and lots of other things like these, as recounted by the poets? These also adorn our sacred places, courtesy of the fine painters, and, in particular, the robe that is carried up to the Acropolis at the Great Panathenaea is full of depictions of this kind. Are we to say that these are all true, Euthyphro?

6b

E: Not only that, Socrates, but, as I said just now, I shall, if you like, relate lots of other stories to you about matters divine, which, on hearing, I know full well you will be astonished.

εὖ εἰδότει περὶ τῶν τοιούτων, ἀνάγκη δὴ, ὡς ἔοικε, καὶ ἡμῖν συγχωρεῖν. τί γὰρ καὶ φήσομεν, οἳ γε καὶ αὐτοὶ ὁμολογοῦμεν περὶ αὐτῶν μηδὲν εἰδέναι; ἀλλὰ μοι εἰπὲ πρὸς Φιλίου, σὺ ὡς ἀληθῶς ἡγῇ ταῦτα οὕτως γεγονέναι; ΕΥΘ. καὶ ἔτι γε τούτων θαυμασιώτερα, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἃ οἱ πολλοὶ οὐκ ἴσασιν. ΣΩ. καὶ πόλεμον ἄρα ἡγῇ σὺ εἶναι τῷ ὄντι ἐν τοῖς θεοῖς πρὸς ἀλλήλους, καὶ ἔχθρας γε δεινὰς καὶ μάχας καὶ ἄλλα τοιαῦτα πολλὰ, οἷα λέγεται τε ὑπὸ τῶν ποιητῶν, καὶ ὑπὸ τῶν

6c

S: I would not be surprised. But you can recount these to me at your leisure on some other occasion. Right now, please try to answer the question I asked you a moment ago, more clearly. For you did not instruct me adequately, my friend, when I asked you earlier what precisely holiness is. Instead, you told me that this action you are performing, prosecuting your father for murder, is holy.

6c

E: And I told you the truth, Socrates.

6c

S: Perhaps, Euthyphro, but in fact you say that lots of other things are holy too.

6c

E: And so they are.

ἀγαθῶν γραφέων τά τε ἄλλα ἱερὰ ἡμῖν καταπεποίκιλται, καὶ δὴ καὶ τοῖς
μεγάλοις Παναθηναίοις ὁ πέπλος μεστὸς τῶν τοιούτων ποικιλμάτων
ἀνάγεται εἰς τὴν ἀκρόπολιν; ταῦτα ἀληθῆ φῶμεν εἶναι, ὦ Εὐθύφρων;
ΕΥΘ. μὴ μόνον γε, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἀλλ' ὅπερ ἄρτι εἶπον, καὶ ἄλλα σοι ἐγὼ
πολλά, ἐάνπερ βούλη, περὶ τῶν θείων διηγήσομαι, ἃ σὺ ἀκούων εὖ οἶδ'
ὅτι ἐκπλαγήσῃ. ΣΩ. οὐκ ἂν θαυμάζοιμι. ἀλλὰ ταῦτα μέν μοι εἰς αὐθις ἐπὶ
σχολῆς διηγήσῃ νυνὶ δὲ ὅπερ ἄρτι σε ἡρόμην πειρῶ

6d

S: May I remind you, Euthyphro, that this is not what I asked you to teach me about – one or two of the many holy actions – but about that very form by which everything that is holy, is holy. For I think you said that what is unholy is unholy, and what is holy is holy, by a single form, or do you not remember?

6d

E: I remember.

6d

S: Well, what precisely is this form? Teach me, so that I may focus upon it, and using this as a standard, declare that any action that is like this standard is holy, and any action that is unlike it is not, whether it is performed by you or by anyone else.

σαφέστερον εἰπεῖν. οὐ γάρ με, ὦ ἑταῖρε, τὸ πρότερον ἱκανῶς ἐδίδαξας
ἐρωτήσαντα τὸ ὅσιον ὅτι ποτ' εἴη, ἀλλὰ μοι εἶπες ὅτι τοῦτο τυγχάνει
ὅσιον ὃν ὃ σὺ νῦν ποιεῖς, φόνου ἐπεξιῶν τῷ πατρί. ΕΥΘ. καὶ ἀληθῆ γε
ἔλεγον, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. ἴσως. ἀλλὰ γάρ, ὦ Εὐθύφρων, καὶ ἄλλα πολλά
φῆς εἶναι ὅσια. ΕΥΘ. καὶ γὰρ ἔστιν. ΣΩ. μέμνησαι οὖν ὅτι οὐ τοῦτό σοι

διεκελευόμεν, ἔν τι ἢ δύο με διδάξαι τῶν πολλῶν ὁσίων, ἀλλ' ἐκεῖνο αὐτὸ τὸ εἶδος ᾧ πάντα τὰ ὅσια ὅσια ἔστιν; ἔφησθα γάρ που μιᾷ ιδέᾳ

6e

E: Well, Socrates, if you want me to express it in those terms, I shall do so.

6e

S: Yes, that is what I want.

6e

E: Well then, what is loved by the gods is holy, but what is not loved by them is unholy.

τά τε ἀνόσια ἀνόσια εἶναι καὶ τὰ ὅσια ὅσια ἢ οὐ μνημονεύεις; ΕΥΘ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. ταύτην τοίνυν με αὐτὴν δίδασκον τὴν ιδέαν τίς ποτέ ἔστιν, ἵνα εἰς ἐκείνην ἀποβλέπων καὶ χρώμενος αὐτῇ παραδείγματι, ὃ μὲν ἂν τοιοῦτον ἦ ὧν ἂν ἢ σὺ ἢ ἄλλος τις πράττει φῶ ὅσιον εἶναι, ὃ δ' ἂν μὴ τοιοῦτον, μὴ φῶ. ΕΥΘ. ἀλλ' εἰ οὕτω βούλει, ὦ Σώκρατες, καὶ οὕτω σοι φράσω. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μὴν βούλομαί γε. ΕΥΘ. ἔστι τοίνυν τὸ μὲν τοῖς θεοῖς προσφιλὲς ὅσιον, τὸ

7a

S: Excellent, Euthyphro! You have now answered in the way that I asked you to answer, although I do not yet know if you have answered truthfully. But of course, you will go on to explain that what you are saying is true.

7a

E: Yes, certainly.

7a

S: Come on then, let us consider what we are saying: whatever is beloved of the gods, and the person who is beloved of the gods, is holy, and whatever is hated by the gods, and whoever is hated by them, is unholy. And the holy is not the same as the unholy, but is its complete opposite. Is this not so?

7a

E: It is so, indeed.

7a

S: And what we are saying is, apparently, correct?

δὲ μὴ προσφιλές ἀνόσιον. ΣΩ. παγκάλως, ὦ Εὐθύφρων, καὶ ὡς ἐγὼ ἐζήτουν ἀποκρίνασθαί σε, οὕτω νῦν ἀπεκρίνω. εἰ μέντοι ἀληθῶς, τοῦτο οὕτω οἶδα, ἀλλὰ σὺ δῆλον ὅτι ἐπεκδιδάξεις ὡς ἔστιν ἀληθὴ ἃ λέγεις. ΕΥΘ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. φέρε δὴ, ἐπισκεψώμεθα τί λέγομεν. τὸ μὲν θεοφιλές τε καὶ θεοφιλὴς ἄνθρωπος ὅσιος, τὸ δὲ θεομισὲς καὶ ὁ θεομισῆς ἀνόσιος· οὐ ταῦτόν δ' ἐστίν, ἀλλὰ τὸ ἐναντιώτατον, τὸ ὅσιον τῷ ἀνοσίῳ· οὐχ οὕτως; ΕΥΘ. οὕτω μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. καὶ εὖ γε φαίνεται εἰρησθαι;

7b

E: I think so, Socrates.

7b

S: But Euthyphro, was it not also stated that the gods quarrel and differ with one another, and that there is enmity between them?

7b

E: Yes, that was stated.

7b

S: But what is the disagreement about when it generates enmity and anger? Let us consider this. Suppose you and I differ about which of two numbers is greater. Would our disagreement about these generate enmity and make us angry with one another, or would we quickly settle these matters by engaging in calculation, in such cases as these at any rate?

ΕΥΘ. δοκῶ, ὦ Σώκρατες, εἴρηται γάρ. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ ὅτι στασιάζουσιν οἱ θεοί, ὦ Εὐθύφρων, καὶ διαφέρονται ἀλλήλοις καὶ ἔχθρα ἐστὶν ἐν αὐτοῖς πρὸς ἀλλήλους, καὶ τοῦτο εἴρηται; ΕΥΘ. εἴρηται γάρ. ΣΩ. ἔχθραν δὲ καὶ ὀργάς, ὦ ἄριστε, ἢ περὶ τίνων διαφορὰ ποιεῖ; ὧδε δὲ σκοπῶμεν. ἄρ' ἂν εἰ διαφεροίμεθα ἐγὼ τε καὶ σὺ περὶ ἀριθμοῦ ὁπότερα πλείω, ἢ περὶ τούτων διαφορὰ ἐχθροὺς ἂν ἡμᾶς ποιοῖ καὶ ὀργίζεσθαι ἀλλήλοις, ἢ ἐπὶ λογισμὸν ἐλθόντες περὶ γε τῶν τοιούτων ταχὺ ἂν

7c

E: Of course.

7c

S: And if we were to differ about the greater and the lesser, we would quickly put an end to our dispute through engaging in measurement?

7c

E: Yes.

7c

S: And I think we would decide about what is heavier and what is lighter by engaging in weighing?

7c

E: Of course.

7c

S: When we become enemies and get angry with one another, what then might our disagreement be about? What issue might we be unable to resolve? Perhaps you cannot answer readily, but I will make a suggestion. Consider if the issue at hand is the just and the unjust, beautiful and ugly, good and bad. Aren't these issues we disagree about, and being unable to come to an adequate resolution do we not become enemies whenever this happens to you and me, or to anyone else?

ἀπαλλαγεῖμεν; ΕΥΘ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ περὶ τοῦ μείζονος καὶ ἐλάττονος εἰ διαφεροίμεθα, ἐπὶ τὸ μετρεῖν ἐλθόντες ταχὺ παυσαίμεθ' ἂν τῆς διαφορᾶς; ΕΥΘ. ἔστι ταῦτα. ΣΩ. καὶ ἐπὶ γε τὸ ἰστάναι ἐλθόντες, ὥς ἐγῶμαι, περὶ τοῦ βαρυτέρου τε καὶ κουφοτέρου διακριθεῖμεν ἄν; ΕΥΘ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΣΩ. περὶ τίνος δὲ δὴ διενεχθέντες καὶ ἐπὶ τίνα κρίσιν οὐ δυνάμενοι ἀφικέσθαι ἐχθροὶ γε ἂν ἀλλήλοις εἶμεν καὶ ὀργιζοίμεθα; ἴσως οὐ πρόχειρόν σοί ἐστιν, ἀλλ' ἐμοῦ λέγοντος

7d

E: Yes, Socrates, this is the disagreement in question, and it concerns these issues.

7d

S: But what about the gods, Euthyphro? If they do, in fact, disagree on anything, would they not disagree on these very issues?

7d

E: This must be so.

σκόπει εἰ τάδε ἐστὶ τό τε δίκαιον καὶ τὸ ἄδικον καὶ καλὸν καὶ αἰσχρὸν καὶ ἀγαθὸν καὶ κακόν. ἄρα οὐ ταῦτά ἐστιν περὶ ὧν διενεχθέντες καὶ οὐδυνάμενοι ἐπὶ ἱκανὴν κρίσιν αὐτῶν ἐλθεῖν ἐχθροὶ ἀλλήλοις γιγνόμεθα, ὅταν γινώμεθα, καὶ ἐγὼ καὶ σὺ καὶ οἱ ἄλλοι ἄνθρωποι πάντες; ΕΥΘ. ἀλλ' ἔστιν αὕτη ἡ διαφορά, ὧ Σώκρατες, καὶ περὶ τούτων. ΣΩ. τί δὲ οἱ θεοί, ὧ Εὐθύφρων; οὐκ εἴπερ τι διαφέρονται, δι' αὐτὰ ταῦτα διαφέρουσιν ἄν; ΕΥΘ. πολλὴ ἀνάγκη.

7e

S: And in fact, according to your account, noble Euthyphro, there are differing views among the gods themselves as to what is just and unjust, beautiful, ugly, good or bad, for they would not have quarrelled with one another if they had not differed on these issues. Is this so?

7e

E: What you are saying is correct.

7e

S: Would not the quarrelling parties love anything they themselves regard as beautiful, good, or just, and would they not hate the opposites of these?

7e

E: Very much so.

ΣΩ. καὶ τῶν θεῶν ἄρα, ὧ γενναῖε Εὐθύφρων, ἄλλοι ἄλλα δίκαια ἡγοῦνται κατὰ τὸν σὸν λόγον, καὶ καλὰ καὶ αἰσχρὰ καὶ ἀγαθὰ καὶ κακά· οὐ γὰρ ἂν που ἐστασίαζον ἀλλήλοις εἰ μὴ περὶ τούτων διεφέροντο· ἦ γάρ; ΕΥΘ. ὁρθῶς λέγεις. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἅπερ καλὰ ἡγοῦνται ἕκαστοι καὶ ἀγαθὰ καὶ δίκαια, ταῦτα καὶ φιλοῦσιν, τὰ δὲ ἐναντία τούτων μισοῦσιν; ΕΥΘ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. ταῦτά δέ γε, ὡς σὺ φής, οἱ μὲν δίκαια ἡγοῦνται,

8a

S: Yes, but according to you, the same things are regarded as just by some gods but unjust by others, and because they disagree on these issues, they quarrel and fight with one another. Is this not so?

8a

E: This is so.

8a

S: Therefore, it seems that the same things are hated by the gods and are loved by them, and what is god-hated and what is god-loved would be the same.

8a

E: So it seems.

8a

S: Then by this argument, the same thing would be both holy and unholy, Euthyphro.

8a

E: Quite likely.

οἱ δὲ ἄδικοι, περὶ ἃ καὶ ἀμφισβητοῦντες στασιάζουσί τε καὶ πολεμοῦσιν ἀλλήλοις· ἄρα οὐχ οὕτω; ΕΥΘ. οὕτω. ΣΩ. ταῦτ' ἄρα, ὡς ἔοικεν, μισεῖται τε ὑπὸ τῶν θεῶν καὶ φιλεῖται, καὶ θεομισῇ τε καὶ θεοφιλῇ ταῦτ' ἂν εἴη. ΕΥΘ. ἔοικεν. ΣΩ. καὶ ὅσια ἄρα καὶ ἀνόσια τὰ αὐτὰ ἂν εἴη, ὧς Εὐθύφρων, τούτῳ τῷ λόγῳ. ΕΥΘ. κινδυνεύει. ΣΩ. οὐκ ἄρα ὁ ἡρόμην ἀπεκρίνω, ὧς θαυμάσιε. οὐ γὰρ τοῦτό γε ἡρώτων, ὃ τυγχάνει ταῦτόν ὃν ὅσιόν τε καὶ ἀνόσιον· ὃ δ' ἂν θεοφιλὲς ᾗ καὶ θεομισὲς ἐστίν, ὡς ἔοικεν.

8b

S: In that case, you did not answer the question I asked you, marvellous one, for I was not asking what is at once both holy and unholy, which would, it seems, be that which is god-loved and that which is god-hated. And so, Euthyphro, it would be no surprise if, in punishing your father as you are doing now, you are doing something that is loved by Zeus but hated by Cronus and Uranus; loved by Hephaestus but hated by Hera; and if any other gods differ with one another on this issue, the same considerations apply.

8b

E: But in my opinion, Socrates, none of the gods differ with one another on this issue; that a man who kills someone unjustly need not

pay the penalty.

8b

S: But, Euthyphro, in the case of us humans, have you ever heard anyone arguing that a man who has killed someone unjustly, or performs any other unjust action whatsoever, should not pay a penalty?

ὥστε, ὦ Εὐθύφρων, ὃ σὺ νῦν ποιεῖς τὸν πατέρα κολάζων, οὐδὲν θαυμαστὸν εἰ τοῦτο δρῶν τῷ μὲν Διὶ προσφιλὲς ποιεῖς, τῷ δὲ Κρόνῳ καὶ τῷ Οὐρανῷ ἐχθρόν, καὶ τῷ μὲν Ἡφαίστῳ φίλον, τῇ δὲ Ἥρᾳ ἐχθρόν, καὶ εἴ τις ἄλλος τῶν θεῶν ἕτερος ἐτέρῳ διαφέρεται περὶ αὐτοῦ, καὶ ἐκείνοις κατὰ τὰ αὐτά. ΕΥΘ. ἀλλ' οἶμαι, ὦ Σώκρατες, περὶ γε τοῦτου τῶν θεῶν οὐδένα ἕτερον ἐτέρῳ διαφέρεισθαι, ὥς οὐ δεῖ δίκην δίδοναι ἐκεῖνον ὃς ἂν ἀδίκως τινὰ ἀποκτείνει. ΣΩ. τί δέ; ἀνθρώπων, ὦ Εὐθύφρων, ἥδη τινὸς ἤκουσας

8c

E: Why, they never stop arguing over these issues, especially in the law courts. Indeed, having performed all sorts of injustices, people do and say anything at all to avoid a penalty.

8c

S: Yes, Euthyphro, but do they also admit that they have acted unjustly, and despite this admission, claim nevertheless that they should not pay a penalty?

8c

E: No, they do not do that at all.

8c

S: Then they do not do or say anything at all. Indeed, I think they would not dare to assert or to argue that they should not pay a penalty, if in fact they have acted unjustly. No, I think they deny that they have acted unjustly. Is this so?

8c

E: That is true.

ἀμφισβητοῦντος ὡς τὸν ἀδίκως ἀποκτείναντα ἢ ἄλλο ἀδίκως ποιοῦντα ὅτι οὐκ οὐ δεῖ δίκην δίδοναι; ΕΥΘ. οὐδὲν μὲν οὖν παύονται ταῦτα ἀμφισβητοῦντες καὶ ἄλλοθι καὶ ἐν τοῖς δικαστηρίοις ἀδικοῦντες γὰρ πάμπολλα, πάντα ποιοῦσι καὶ λέγουσι φεύγοντες τὴν δίκην. ΣΩ. ἦ καὶ ὁμολογοῦσιν, ὦ Εὐθύφρων, ἀδικεῖν, καὶ ὁμολογοῦντες ὅμως οὐ δεῖν φασὶ σφᾶς δίδοναι δίκην; ΕΥΘ. οὐδαμῶς τοῦτό γε. ΣΩ. οὐκ ἄρα πᾶν γε ποιοῦσι καὶ λέγουσι τοῦτο γὰρ οἶμαι οὐ τολμῶσι λέγειν οὐδ' ἀμφισβητεῖν, ὡς οὐχὶ εἶπερ

8d

S: So they do not argue that the person who commits injustice should not pay a penalty. They surely argue, instead, over who the wrongdoer is, what he did, and when.

8d

E: That is true.

8d

S: Do not the same considerations also apply to the gods, if they do indeed quarrel about justice and injustice, as you maintain, and one side claims that the other is acting unjustly, while the other side denies it? But this much is certain, my friend, no one, neither god nor human, would dare to suggest that a person who acts unjustly should not pay a penalty.

8d

E: Yes, Socrates, what you are saying is true, on the whole.

8d

S: Yes, I think those who differ, be they humans or gods, if indeed gods do differ, differ over particular actions. When they differ over any action, some maintain that it was performed in a just manner, others that it was performed in an unjust manner. Isn't this so?

8d

E: Entirely so.

ἀδικοῦσί γε δοτέον δίκην, ἀλλ' οἶμαι οὐ φασιν ἀδικεῖν ἢ γάρ; ΕΥΘ. ἀληθῆ λέγεις. ΣΩ. οὐκ ἄρα ἐκεῖνό γε ἀμφισβητοῦσιν, ὡς οὐ τὸν

ἀδικοῦντα δεῖ διδόναι δίκην, ἀλλ' ἐκεῖνο ἴσως ἀμφισβητοῦσιν, τὸ τίς ἐστὶν ὁ ἀδικῶν καὶ τί δρῶν καὶ πότε. ΕΥΘ. ἀληθῆ λέγεις. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν αὐτὰ γε ταῦτα καὶ οἱ θεοὶ πεπόνθασιν, εἴπερ στασιάζουσι περὶ τῶν δικαίων καὶ ἀδίκων ὡς ὁ σὸς λόγος, καὶ οἱ μὲν φασιν ἀλλήλους ἀδικεῖν, οἱ δὲ οὐ φασιν; ἐπεὶ ἐκεῖνό γε δήπου, ὦ θαυμάσιε, οὐδεὶς οὔτε θεῶν οὔτε

8e

S: Come on then, dear Euthyphro, and instruct me so that I may become wiser. What evidence do you have that all the gods think that this man met his death unjustly, a man who committed murder whilst working as a day-labourer, who was tied up by the master of the murder victim, and who died prematurely on account of his bonds, before the master, who had tied him up, had found out from the legal expositor what he should do about him. Where is your evidence that it is actually right for a son to prosecute his father, and denounce him, on behalf of a person like that? Come on, try to demonstrate these points clearly to me, that all of the gods really do believe that this course of action is right, and if you prove this to me adequately, I shall sing the praises of your wisdom unceasingly.

ἀνθρώπων τολμᾷ λέγειν, ὡς οὐ τῷ γε ἀδικοῦντι δοτέον δίκην. ΕΥΘ. ναί, τοῦτο μὲν ἀληθὲς λέγεις, ὦ Σώκρατες, τό γε κεφάλαιον. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' ἕκαστόν γε οἶμαι, ὦ Εὐθύφρων, τῶν πραχθέντων ἀμφισβητοῦσιν οἱ ἀμφισβητοῦντες, καὶ ἄνθρωποι καὶ θεοί, εἴπερ ἀμφισβητοῦσιν θεοί· πράξεώς τινος πέρι διαφερόμενοι οἱ μὲν δικαίως φασὶν αὐτὴν πεπραῆχθαι, οἱ δὲ ἀδίκως· ἄρ' οὐχ οὕτω; ΕΥΘ. πάννυ γε. ΣΩ. ἴθι νυν, ὦ φίλε Εὐθύφρων, δίδασον καὶ ἐμέ, ἵνα σοφώτερος γένωμαι, τί σοι τεκμήριόν ἐστιν ὡς πάντες θεοὶ ἡγοῦνται ἐκεῖνον ἀδίκως τεθνάναι, ὃς ἂν θητεύων ἀνδροφόνος γενόμενος, συνδεθείς ὑπὸ τοῦ δεσπότη τοῦ ἀποθανόντος, φθάσῃ τελευτήσας διὰ τὰ δεσμὰ πρὶν τὸν συνδήσαντα παρὰ τῶν ἐξηγητῶν περὶ αὐτοῦ πυθέσθαι τί χρὴ ποιεῖν, καὶ ὑπὲρ τοῦ τοιούτου δὴ ὀρθῶς ἔχει ἐπεξιέναι καὶ ἐπισκῆπτεσθαι φόνου τὸν ὕον τῷ πατρί; ἴθι, περὶ τούτων πειρῶ τί μοι

9b

E: Well, that is surely no small task, Socrates, yet I should be able to demonstrate it to you very clearly.

9b

S: I understand. That is because you think that I am a slower learner than the jurors, since you will, of course, prove to them that these actions are unjust, and that all of the gods hate such actions as these.

9b

E: Very clearly, Socrates, if they will only listen to what I say.

9b

S: They will listen alright, Euthyphro, provided they think you are speaking well. But while you were speaking something occurred to me, and I am thinking to myself, “If Euthyphro were to teach me, comprehensively, that all the gods regard a death like this one to be unjust, what more have I learned from Euthyphro as to what exactly holiness and unholiness are? Yes, this particular action would, it seems, be god-hated, but it turned out earlier that what is holy and what is not are not defined by this, for what is god-hated proved also to be god-loved.” So if you like, Euthyphro, I will grant you this: let all the gods think it unjust, and let them all hate it.

But what about this correction we have just introduced into the argument, according to which whatever all the gods hate is unholy, and whatever they all love is holy, and whatever some love and others hate is neither or both. Would you like us now to define what is holy and what is unholy in this way?

σαφές ἐνδείξασθαι ὥς παντὸς μᾶλλον πάντες θεοὶ ἡγοῦνται ὀρθῶς ἔχειν ταύτην τὴν πράξιν· κἄν μοι ἱκανῶς ἐνδείξῃ, ἐγκωμιάζων σε ἐπὶ σοφίᾳ οὐδέποτε παύσομαι. ΕΥΘ. ἀλλ’ ἴσως οὐκ ὀλίγον ἔργον ἐστίν, ὃ Σώκρατες, ἐπεὶ πάνυ γε σαφῶς ἔχοιμι ἂν ἐπιδείξαι σοι. ΣΩ. μανθάνω· ὅτι σοι δοκῶ τῶν δικαστῶν δυσμαθέστερος εἶναι, ἐπεὶ ἐκείνοις γε ἐνδείξῃ δῆλον ὅτι ὥς ἄδικά τέ ἐστιν καὶ οἱ θεοὶ ἅπαντες τὰ τοιαῦτα μισοῦσιν. ΕΥΘ. πάνυ γε σαφῶς, ὃ Σώκρατες, ἐάνπερ ἀκούωσί γέ μου λέγοντος. ΣΩ. ἀλλ’ ἀκούσονται. ἐάνπερ εὖ δοκῇς λέγειν. τόδε δέ σου

ἐνενόησα ἅμα λέγοντος καὶ πρὸς ἑμαυτὸν σκοπῶ· εἰ ὅτι μάλιστά με Εὐθύφρων διδάξειεν ὥς οἱ θεοὶ ἅπαντες τὸν τοιοῦτον θάνατον ἡγοῦνται ἄδικον εἶναι, τί μᾶλλον ἐγὼ μεμάθηκα παρ' Εὐθύφρονος τί ποτ' ἐστὶν τὸ ὁσιόν τε καὶ τὸ ἀνόσιον; θεομισὲς μὲν γὰρ τοῦτο τὸ ἔργον, ὥς ἔοικεν, εἶη ἄν. ἀλλὰ γὰρ οὐ τοῦτω ἐφάνη ἄρτι ὠρισμένα τὸ ὁσιον καὶ μὴ τὸ γὰρ θεομισὲς ὃν καὶ θεοφιλὲς ἐφάνη. ὥστε τούτου μὲν ἀφίημί σε, ὦ Εὐθύφρων· εἰ βούλει, πάντες αὐτὸ

9d

E: Is there any reason not to, Socrates?

9d

S: In my case no, Euthyphro, but in your own case, you should decide whether adopting this hypothesis is the easiest way for you to teach me what you promised.

ἡγείσθων θεοὶ ἄδικον καὶ πάντες μισούντων. ἀλλ' ἄρα τοῦτο ὃ νῦν ἐπανορθούμεθα ἐν τῷ λόγῳ—ὥς ὃ μὲν ἂν πάντες οἱ θεοὶ μισῶσιν ἀνόσιόν ἐστιν, ὃ δ' ἂν φιλῶσιν, ὅσιον· ὃ δ' ἂν οἱ μὲν φιλῶσιν οἱ δὲ μισῶσιν, οὐδέτερα ἢ ἀμφοτέρα—ἄρ' οὕτω βούλει ἡμῖν ὠρίσθαι νῦν περὶ τοῦ ὁσίου καὶ τοῦ ἀνοσίου; ΕΥΘ. τί γὰρ κωλύει, ὦ Σώκρατες; γ ΣΩ. οὐδὲν ἐμέ γε, ὦ Εὐθύφρων, ἀλλὰ σὺ δὴ τὸ σὸν σκόπει, εἰ τοῦτο ὑποθέμενος οὕτω ῥᾷστά με διδάξεις ὃ ὑπέσχου.

9e

E: Well, I would say that what is holy is what all the gods love, and its opposite, what all the gods hate, is unholy.

9e

S: Should we also investigate whether this formulation is correct, Euthyphro? Or should we leave it, and accept our own or other people's assertions just like that, agreeing that this is the case just because somebody says so? Or should we consider what the speaker means?

9e

E: We should consider that. However, in my view, this is now a good formulation.

ΕΥΘ. ἀλλ' ἔγωγε φαίην ἂν τοῦτο εἶναι τὸ ὅσιον ὃ ἂν πάντες οἱ θεοὶ φιλῶσιν, καὶ τὸ ἐναντίον, ὃ ἂν πάντες θεοὶ μισῶσιν, ἀνόσιον. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἐπισκοπῶμεν αὖ τοῦτο, ὃ Εὐθύφρων, εἰ καλῶς λέγεται, ἢ ἐῷμεν καὶ οὕτω ἡμῶν τε αὐτῶν ἀποδεχώμεθα καὶ τῶν ἄλλων, ἐὰν μόνον φῇ τίς τι ἔχειν οὕτω συγχωροῦντες ἔχειν; ἢ σκεπτέον τί λέγει ὁ λέγων; ΕΥΘ. σκεπτέον· οἶμαι μέντοι ἔγωγε τοῦτο νυνὶ καλῶς λέγεσθαι.

10a

S: Good man. We shall know better soon enough. Yes, think about this. Is the holy loved by the gods because it is holy, or is it holy because it is loved?

10a

E: I do not understand what you are saying, Socrates.

10a

S: Then I shall try to speak with greater clarity. We say that something is carried and something carries, something is led and something leads, something is seen and something sees. And in all these cases, do you understand that there are differences between them, and the way in which they differ?

10a

E: I think I understand.

10a

S: And is there something that is loved, and is that different from that which loves?

10a

E: Of course.

ΣΩ. τάχ', ὡγαθέ, βέλτιον εἰσόμεθα. ἐννόησον γὰρ τὸ τοιόνδε· ἄρα τὸ ὅσιον ὅτι ὀσιόν ἐστιν φιλεῖται ὑπὸ τῶν θεῶν, ἢ ὅτι φιλεῖται ὀσιόν ἐστιν; ΕΥΘ. οὐκ οἶδ' ὅτι λέγεις, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' ἐγὼ πειράσομαι σαφέστερον φράσαι. λέγομέν τι φερόμενον καὶ φέρον καὶ ἀγόμενον καὶ ἄγον καὶ ὀρώμενον καὶ ὀρών καὶ πάντα τὰ τοιαῦτα μανθάνεις ὅτι ἕτερα ἀλλήλων ἐστὶ καὶ ἢ ἕτερα; ΕΥΘ. ἔγωγέ μοι δοκῶ μανθάνειν. ΣΩ.

οὐκοῦν καὶ φιλούμενόν τί ἐστὶν καὶ τούτου ἕτερον τὸ φιλοῦν; ΕΥΘ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ;

10b

S: Then, tell me whether something that is carried is what it is because it is being carried, or for some other reason?

10b

E: No, that is the reason.

10b

S: And something that is led is what it is because it is being led, and something that is seen is what it is because it is being seen.

10b

E: Yes, certainly.

10b

S: So, it is not because it is a seen thing that it is seen. It is the other way around: because it is seen it is a seen thing. Nor is it because it is a thing led that it is led. No, because it is led it is a thing led. Nor is it because it is a thing carried that it is carried. No, because it is carried it is a thing carried. So Euthyphro, is it obvious what I wish to say? What I mean is this. If anything becomes, or is affected, it is not because it is a thing that becomes that it becomes. No, because it becomes it is a thing that becomes. Nor is it because it is a thing affected that it is affected. No, because it is affected it is a thing affected. Do you agree that this is so?

ΣΩ. λέγε δή μοι, πότερον τὸ φερόμενον διότι φέρεται φερόμενόν ἐστιν, ἢ δι' ἄλλο τι; ΕΥΘ. οὐκ, ἀλλὰ διὰ τοῦτο. ΣΩ. καὶ τὸ ἀγόμενον δὴ διότι ἄγεται, καὶ τὸ ὀρώμενον διότι ὀράται; ΕΥΘ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. οὐκ ἄρα διότι ὀρώμενόν γέ ἐστιν, διὰ τοῦτο ὀράται, ἀλλὰ τὸ ἐναντίον διότι ὀράται, διὰ τοῦτο ὀρώμενον· οὐδὲ διότι ἀγόμενόν ἐστιν, διὰ τοῦτο ἄγεται, ἀλλὰ διότι ἄγεται, διὰ τοῦτο ἀγόμενον· οὐδὲ διότι φερόμενον φέρεται, ἀλλὰ διότι φέρεται φερόμενον. ἄρα κατάδηλον, ὦ Εὐθύφρων, ὅ

10c

E: I do.

10c

S: Now, is not that which is loved either something that is becoming, or something that is being affected by something?

10c

E: Yes, certainly.

10c

S: And this case is like the previous cases. It is not because it is a thing loved that it is loved by those who love it. No, because it is loved it is a thing that is loved.

βούλομαι λέγειν; βούλομαι δὲ τόδε, ὅτι εἴ τι γίγνεται ἢ τι πάσχει, οὐχ ὅτι γιγνόμενόν ἐστι γίγνεται, ἀλλ' ὅτι γίγνεται γιγνόμενόν ἐστιν· οὐδ' ὅτι πάσχον ἐστὶ πάσχει, ἀλλ' ὅτι πάσχει πάσχον ἐστίν· ἢ οὐ συγχωρεῖς οὕτως; ΕΥΘ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ τὸ φιλούμενον ἢ γιγνόμενόν τί ἐστιν ἢ πάσχον τι ὑπὸ του; ΕΥΘ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. καὶ τοῦτο ἄρα οὕτως ἔχει ὥσπερ τὰ πρότερα· οὐχ ὅτι φιλούμενόν ἐστιν φιλεῖται ὑπὸ ὧν φιλεῖται, ἀλλ' ὅτι φιλεῖται φιλούμενον; ΕΥΘ. ἀνάγκη.

10d

E: Necessarily.

10d

S: Well then, what do we say about what is holy, Euthyphro? Is it not loved by all the gods, according to your argument?

10d

E: Yes.

10d

S: So, is this because it is holy, or for some other reason?

10d

E: No, that is the reason.

10d

S: So, because it is holy it is loved. It is not the case that it is loved and for that reason is holy?

10d

E: It seems so.

10d

S: And yet, because something is loved by the gods, it is a thing that is loved and is god-loved.

10d

E: Of course.

10d

S: Therefore, what is god-loved is not holy, Euthyphro, nor is the holy god-loved, as you maintain. They are different from one another.

10d

E: How so, Socrates?

ΣΩ. τί δὴ οὖν λέγομεν περὶ τοῦ ὁσίου, ὃ Εὐθύφρων; ἄλλο τι φιλεῖται ὑπὸ θεῶν πάντων, ὥς ὁ σὸς λόγος; γ ΕΥΘ. ναί. ΣΩ. ἄρα διὰ τοῦτο, ὅτι ὁσιόν ἐστιν, ἢ δι' ἄλλο τι; ΕΥΘ. οὐκ, ἀλλὰ διὰ τοῦτο. ΣΩ. διότι ἄρα ὁσιόν ἐστιν φιλεῖται, ἀλλ' οὐχ ὅτι φιλεῖται, διὰ τοῦτο ὁσιόν ἐστιν; ΕΥΘ. ἔοικεν. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μὲν δὴ διότι γε φιλεῖται ὑπὸ θεῶν φιλούμενόν ἐστι καὶ θεοφιλές. ΕΥΘ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΣΩ. οὐκ ἄρα τὸ θεοφιλές ὁσιόν ἐστιν, ὃ Εὐθύφρων, οὐδὲ τὸ ὁσιον θεοφιλές, ὥς σὺ λέγεις, ἀλλ' ἕτερον τοῦτο τούτου.

10e

S: Because we agree that what is holy is loved because it is holy, and it is not because it is loved that it is holy. Is this so?

10e

E: Yes.

10e

S: And yet, what is god-loved is beloved of the gods by reason of their very love. But the reason it is loved is not that it is god-loved.

10e

E: That is true.

10e

S: But dear Euthyphro, if what is god-loved and what is holy were the same, then if what is holy was loved because of being holy, what is god-loved too would be loved because of being god-loved. And if, on the

other hand, what is god-loved was god-loved because of being loved by the gods, what is holy too would be holy because of being loved. But you can now see that these two are opposites. They are completely different from one another. For one is a loved thing because it is loved, while the other is a loved thing, and is loved for that reason. And Euthyphro, when I asked what precisely the holy is, it seems you were not willing to disclose its essence to me, but only to describe something it undergoes, that what is holy is affected as follows: it is loved by all the gods. But you have not yet said what it actually is. So if you please, do not hide this from me, but tell me again from the beginning what precisely the holy is, regardless of whether it is loved by the gods or whatever else happens to it, for we shall not argue over that. Just state what holiness and unholiness are, and do not hold back.

ΕΥΘ. πῶς δῆ, ὦ Σώκρατες; ΣΩ. ὅτι ὁμολογοῦμεν τὸ μὲν ὅσιον διὰ τοῦτο φιλεῖσθαι, ὅτι ὅσιόν ἐστιν, ἀλλ' οὐ διότι φιλεῖται ὅσιον εἶναι· ἢ γάρ; ΕΥΘ. ναί. ΣΩ. τὸ δέ γε θεοφιλὲς ὅτι φιλεῖται ὑπὸ θεῶν, αὐτῷ τούτῳ τῷ φιλεῖσθαι θεοφιλὲς εἶναι, ἀλλ' οὐχ ὅτι θεοφιλὲς, διὰ τοῦτο φιλεῖσθαι. ΕΥΘ. ἀληθῆ λέγεις. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' εἴ γε ταυτὸν ἦν, ὦ φίλε Εὐθύφρων, τὸ θεοφιλὲς καὶ τὸ ὅσιον, εἰ μὲν διὰ τὸ ὅσιον εἶναι ἐφιλεῖτο τὸ ὅσιον, καὶ διὰ τὸ θεοφιλὲς εἶναι ἐφιλεῖτο ἂν τὸ θεοφιλὲς, εἰ δὲ διὰ τὸ φιλεῖσθαι ὑπὸ θεῶν τὸ θεοφιλὲς θεοφιλὲς ἦν, καὶ τὸ ὅσιον ἂν διὰ τὸ φιλεῖσθαι ὅσιον ἦν· νῦν δὲ ὁρᾷς ὅτι ἐναντίως ἔχεται, ὥς παντάπασιν ἐτέρῳ ὄντε ἀλλήλων. τὸ μὲν γάρ, ὅτι φιλεῖται, ἐστὶν οἷον φιλεῖσθαι· τὸ δ' ὅτι ἐστὶν οἷον φιλεῖσθαι, διὰ τοῦτο φιλεῖται. καὶ κινδυνεύεις, ὦ Εὐθύφρων, ἐρωτώμενος τὸ ὅσιον ὅτι ποτ' ἐστίν, τὴν μὲν οὐσίαν μοι αὐτοῦ οὐ βούλεσθαι δηλῶσαι, πάθος δέ τι περὶ αὐτοῦ λέγειν, ὅτι πέπονθε τοῦτο τὸ ὅσιον, φιλεῖσθαι ὑπὸ πάντων

11b

E: But Socrates, I do not know how to tell you what I have in mind. For anything we propose always wanders about somehow and will not stay where we put it.

11b

S: These pronouncements of yours, Euthyphro, seem to be like the works of my own ancestor, Daedalus,⁴ and if I was the one who had proposed them and set them down, you would probably have mocked me over my kinship to that man, because my verbal formulations run away and refuse to remain where someone puts them. But now, of course, the hypotheses are yours, so some alternative mockery is called for since they refuse to remain in place for you, as you can see for yourself.

θεῶν· ὅτι δὲ ὄν, οὕτω εἶπες. εἰ οὖν σοι φίλον, μή με ἀποκρύψῃ ἀλλὰ πάλιν εἰπὲ ἐξ ἀρχῆς τί ποτε ὄν τὸ ὅσιον εἴτε φιλεῖται ὑπὸ θεῶν εἴτε ὅτιδὲ πάσχει—οὐ γὰρ περὶ τούτου διοισόμεθα—ἀλλ’ εἰπὲ προθύμως τί ἐστὶν τό τε ὅσιον καὶ τὸ ἀνόσιον; ΕΥΘ. ἀλλ’, ὦ Σώκρατες, οὐκ ἔχω ἔγωγε ὅπως σοι εἶπω ὃ νοῶ περιέρχεται γάρ πως ἡμῖν αἰὲ ὃ ἂν προθύμεθα καὶ οὐκ ἐθέλει μένειν ὅπου ἂν ἰδρυσώμεθα αὐτό. ΣΩ. τοῦ ἡμετέρου προγόνου, ὦ Εὐθύφρων, ἔοικεν εἶναι Δαιδάλου τὰ ὑπὸ σοῦ λεγόμενα. καὶ εἰ μὲν αὐτὰ ἐγὼ ἔλεγον καὶ ἐτιθέμην, ἴσως ἂν με ἐπέσκωπτες ὥς ἄρα καὶ ἐμοὶ κατὰ τὴν ἐκείνου συγγένειαν τὰ ἐν τοῖς λόγοις ἔργα ἀποδιδράσκει καὶ οὐκ ἐθέλει μένειν ὅπου ἂν τις αὐτὰ θῇ· νῦν δὲ σαὶ γὰρ αἱ ὑποθέσεις εἰσὶν. ἄλλου δὲ τινος δεῖ σκώμματος· οὐ γὰρ ἐθέλουσι σοὶ μένειν, ὥς καὶ αὐτῷ σοι δοκεῖ. ΕΥΘ. ἐμοὶ δὲ δοκεῖ σχεδόν τι τοῦ αὐτοῦ σκώμματος, ὦ Σώκρατες, δεῖσθαι τὰ λεγόμενα· τὸ γὰρ περιέναι αὐτοῖς τοῦτο καὶ μὴ μένειν ἐν τῷ αὐτῷ οὐκ ἐγὼ εἶμι ὁ ἐντιθείς,

11d

E: But I think the pronouncements deserve more or less the same mockery, Socrates, for I am not the one who set them in motion so that they do not remain in the same place. No, it seems to me that you are the ‘Daedalus’, since if it were up to me they would have remained as they were.

11d

S: Perhaps, my friend, I have become cleverer at the craft than that ancestor of mine, to this extent: while he only made his own works unstable, it seems I do this to my own and to other people’s too. And,

indeed, what is most delightful about the skill in my case is that I am wise against my will, for I would have preferred that my own pronouncements be stable, fixed and unmoving, rather than possess the wisdom of Daedalus and the wealth of Tantalus⁵ too. But enough of all this. Since you yourself seem to be indolent, I will join you in your desire to instruct me about what is holy. Do not give up yet. Think about this: is everything that is holy necessarily just?

ἀλλὰ σύ μοι δοκεῖς ὁ Δαίδαλος, ἐπεὶ ἐμοῦ γε ἔνεκα ἔμενεν ἅν ταῦτα οὕτως. ΣΩ. κινδυνεύω ἄρα, ὦ ἐταῖρε, ἐκείνου τοῦ ἀνδρὸς δεινότερος γεγονέναι τὴν τέχνην τοσοῦτω, ὅσῳ ὁ μὲν τὰ αὐτοῦ μόνα ἐποίει οὐ μένοντα, ἐγὼ δὲ πρὸς τοῖς ἑμαυτοῦ, ὡς ἔοικε, καὶ τὰ ἀλλότρια. καὶ δῆτα τοῦτό μοι τῆς τέχνης ἐστὶ κομψότατον, ὅτι ἄκων εἰμὶ σοφός· ἐβουλόμην γὰρ ἅν μοι τοὺς λόγους μένειν καὶ ἀκινήτως ἰδρῦσθαι μᾶλλον ἢ πρὸς τῇ

11e

E: I think so.

Δαϊδάλου σοφία τὰ Ταντάλου χρήματα γενέσθαι. καὶ τούτων μὲν ἄδην· ἐπειδὴ δέ μοι δοκεῖς σὺ τρυφᾶν, αὐτός σοι συμπροθυμήσομαι δεῖξαι ὅπως ἅν με διδάξης περὶ τοῦ ὁσίου. καὶ μὴ προαποκάμης· ἰδὲ γὰρ εἰ οὐκ ἀναγκαῖόν σοι δοκεῖ δίκαιον εἶναι πᾶν τὸ ὅσιον. ΕΥΘ. ἔμοιγε. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν καὶ πᾶν τὸ δίκαιον ὅσιον; ἢ τὸ μὲν ὅσιον

12a

S: And is everything that is just, also holy? Or is what is holy all just, while what is just is not all holy, part of it being holy and part something else?

12a

E: Socrates, I cannot follow you.

12a

S: And yet you are younger than me, and no less wise, for that. But as I said, your wealth of wisdom makes you indolent. So exert yourself, blessed man, for it is not difficult to understand what I mean. Indeed, I am saying the opposite of the poet who wrote these lines:

*Zeus the creator, who made all this, you shrink from reviling,
For when there is fear there is also reverence.⁶*

Now, I disagree with this poet. Shall I tell you why?

πᾶν δίκαιον, τὸ δὲ δίκαιον οὐ πᾶν ὅσιον, ἀλλὰ τὸ μὲν αὐτοῦ ὅσιον, τὸ δέ τι καὶ ἄλλο; ΕΥΘ. οὐχ ἔπομαι, ὦ Σώκρατες, τοῖς λεγομένοις. ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν νεώτερός γέ μου εἶ οὐκ ἔλαττον ἢ ὅσω σοφώτερος· ἀλλ', ὃ λέγω, τρυφᾷς ὑπὸ πλούτου τῆς σοφίας. ἀλλ', ὦ μακάριε, σύντεινε σαυτόν· καὶ γὰρ οὐδὲ χαλεπὸν κατανοῆσαι ὃ λέγω. λέγω γὰρ δὴ τὸ ἐναντίον ἢ ὁ ποιητῆς ἐποίησεν ὁ ποιήσας—Ζῆνα δὲ τὸν θ' ἔρξαντα καὶ ὃς τάδε πάντ' ἐφύτευσεν

12b

E: Yes, certainly.

12b

S: I do not think that 'when there is fear there is also reverence', because I think that many people who fear disease and poverty, and lots of other things like these, are afraid, yet they are not at all ashamed of the things they fear. Is this not how it seems to you too?

12b

E: Yes, certainly.

12b

S: But I do think that when there is reverence, there is also fear. Indeed, is there anyone who is ashamed of something, feels shame, and is not at the same time fearful, and afraid of a reputation for wickedness?

οὐκ ἐθέλει νεικεῖν· ἵνα γὰρ δέος ἔνθα καὶ αἰδώς. ἐγὼ οὖν τούτῳ διαφέρομαι τῷ ποιητῇ. εἶπω σοι ὅπη; ΕΥΘ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. οὐ δοκεῖ μοι εἶναι ἵνα δέος ἔνθα καὶ αἰδώς πολλοὶ γάρ μοι δοκοῦσι καὶ νόσους καὶ πενίας καὶ ἄλλα πολλὰ τοιαῦτα δεδιότες δεδιέναι μὲν, αἰδεῖσθαι δὲ μὴδὲν ταῦτα ἃ δεδίασιν· οὐ καὶ σοὶ δοκεῖ; ΕΥΘ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' ἵνα γε

αἰδῶς ἔνθα καὶ δέος εἶναι· ἐπεὶ ἔστιν ὅστις αἰδούμενός τι πράγμα καὶ αἰσχυνόμενος οὐ πεφόβηται

12c

E: Yes, he is afraid.

12c

S: So, it is not right to say that ‘when there is fear there is also reverence’. On the contrary, when there is reverence there is also fear, and yet when there is fear there is not reverence in every case, for I think that fear is more extensive than reverence. Indeed, reverence is a part of fear, just as odd is part of number, and so it is not the case that when there is number there is also the odd, and yet where there is the odd there is also number. So I presume you follow me now.

12c

E: Yes, certainly.

τε καὶ δέδοικεν ἅμα δόξαν πονηρίας; ΕΥΘ. δέδοικε μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. οὐκ ἄρ’ ὀρθῶς ἔχει λέγειν· ἵνα γὰρ δέος ἔνθα καὶ αἰδῶς, ἀλλ’ ἵνα μὲν αἰδῶς ἔνθα καὶ δέος, οὐ μέντοι ἵνα γε δέος πανταχοῦ αἰδῶς· ἐπὶ πλέον γὰρ οἶμαι δέος αἰδοῦς. μόριον γὰρ αἰδῶς δέους ὥσπερ ἀριθμοῦ περιττόν, ὥστε οὐχ ἵναπερ ἀριθμὸς ἔνθα καὶ περιττόν, ἵνα δὲ περιττόν ἔνθα καὶ ἀριθμός. ἔπη γάρ που νῦν γε; ΕΥΘ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. τὸ τοιοῦτον τοίνυν καὶ ἐκεῖ λέγων ἡρώτων· ἄρα ἵνα

12d

S: Well, this is more or less what I meant by the earlier question. When there is justice, is there also holiness? Or when there is holiness, is there also justice? While conversely, when there is justice, there is not holiness in every case, because holiness is a part of justice? Should we say this, or do you think otherwise?

12d

E: No, let us say this. I think you are expressing this correctly.

12d

S: Then, take note of the next issue, for if holiness is part of justice, we should, it seems, find out what part it would be. Now, suppose you had

asked me about something we have just discussed, number, for instance, what part of number is the even part, and what kind of number it is, I would reply that it has equal sides rather than unequal sides.⁷ Is that what you think?

12d

E: It is.

δίκαιον ἔνθα καὶ ὅσιον; ἢ ἵνα μὲν ὅσιον ἔνθα καὶ δίκαιον, ἵνα δὲ δίκαιον οὐ πανταχοῦ ὅσιον· μόριον γὰρ τοῦ δικαίου τὸ ὅσιον; οὕτω φῶμεν ἢ ἄλλως σοι δοκεῖ; ΕΥΘ. οὐκ, ἀλλ' οὕτω. φαίνη γάρ μοι ὀρθῶς λέγειν. ΣΩ. ὅρα δὴ τὸ μετὰ τοῦτο. εἰ γὰρ μέρος τὸ ὅσιον τοῦ δικαίου, δεῖ δὴ ἡμᾶς, ὡς ἔοικεν, ἐξευρεῖν τὸ ποῖον μέρος ἂν εἴη τοῦ δικαίου τὸ ὅσιον. εἰ μὲν οὖν σύ με ἠρώτας τι τῶν νυνδὴ, οἷον ποῖον μέρος ἐστὶν ἀριθμοῦ τὸ ἄρτιον καὶ τίς ὢν τυγχάνει οὗτος ὁ ἀριθμός, εἶπον ἂν ὅτι ὅς ἂν μὴ σκαληνός ᾖ ἀλλ' ἰσοσκελὴς ἢ οὐ δοκεῖ σοι; ΕΥΘ. ἔμοιγε.

12e

S: So you should now also attempt to teach me, in this way, the part of justice that is holy, so that I may tell Meletus not to wrong me anymore, or to prosecute me for impiety, as I have now received adequate instruction from you about what is pious and holy, and what is not.

ΣΩ. πειρῶ δὴ καὶ σὺ ἐμὲ οὕτω διδάξαι τὸ ποῖον μέρος τοῦ δικαίου ὅσιόν ἐστιν, ἵνα καὶ Μελήτω λέγωμεν μηκέθ' ἡμᾶς ἀδικεῖν μηδὲ ἀσεβείας γράφεσθαι, ὡς ἱκανῶς ἤδη παρὰ σοῦ μεμαθηκότας τά τε εὐσεβῆ καὶ ὅσια καὶ τὰ μή. ΕΥΘ. τοῦτο τοίνυν ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ, ὦ Σώκρατες, τὸ μέρος τοῦ δικαίου εἶναι εὐσεβές τε καὶ ὅσιον, τὸ περὶ τὴν τῶν θεῶν θεραπείαν, τὸ δὲ περὶ τὴν τῶν ἀνθρώπων τὸ λοιπὸν εἶναι τοῦ δικαίου μέρος. ΣΩ. καὶ καλῶς γέ μοι, ὦ Εὐθύφρων, φαίνη λέγειν, ἀλλὰ

13a

E: Well, Socrates, it seems to me that the part of justice that is pious and holy is the part that deals with care of the gods, while the remaining part of justice deals with care of human beings.

13a

S: And, in my view, you have expressed that well, Euthyphro. But there is one minor detail still outstanding, for I do not yet understand what the care you are referring to actually is. For I presume you do not mean that the sort of care that deals with the gods is just like the care that deals with anything else. Yes, is this not how we speak? We say, for instance, that not everyone knows how to care for horses, only the skilled horse-trainer. Is this so?

13a

E: Very much so.

13a

S: For horse-training is, presumably, the care of horses?

13a

E: Yes.

σμικροῦ τινος ἔτι ἐνδεής εἰμι· τὴν γὰρ θεραπείαν οὐπω συνίημι ἦντινα ὀνομάζεις. οὐ γάρ που λέγεις γε, οἷαίπερ καὶ αἱ περὶ τὰ ἄλλα θεραπειαὶ εἰσιν, τοιαύτην καὶ περὶ θεοῦς— λέγομεν γάρ που—οἷόν φαμεν ἵππους οὐ πᾶς ἐπίσταται θεραπεύειν ἀλλὰ ὁ ἵππικός· ἦ γάρ; ΕΥΘ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. ἡ γάρ που ἵππικὴ ἵππων θεραπεία. ΕΥΘ. ναί. ΣΩ. οὐδέ γε κύνας πᾶς ἐπίσταται θεραπεύειν ἀλλὰ ὁ κυνηγετικός. ΕΥΘ. οὕτω. ΣΩ. ἡ γάρ που κυνηγετικὴ κυνῶν θεραπεία.

13b

S: Nor, for that matter, does everyone know how to care for dogs, only the dog-handler?

13b

E: Quite so.

13b

S: For dog-handling is, presumably, the care of dogs?

13b

E: Yes.

13b

S: And ox-herding of oxen?

13b

E: Very much so.

13b

S: And holiness and piety are the care of gods, Euthyphro. Is this what you mean?

13b

E: I do.

13b

S: And does not all care bring about the same outcome? Something like this: it is directed to some good or some benefit of whatever is cared for. For instance, you can see that horses cared for by horse-training are benefited and become better. Do you not think so?

13b

E: I do.

ΕΥΘ. ναί. ΣΩ. ἡ δέ γε βοηλατικὴ βοῶν. ΕΥΘ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. ἡ δὲ δὴ ὁσιότης τε καὶ εὐσέβεια θεῶν, ὧ Εὐθύφρων; οὕτω λέγεις; ΕΥΘ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν θεραπεία γε πᾶσα ταῦτὸν διαπράττεται; οἷον τοιόνδε· ἐπ' ἀγαθῷ τινὶ ἔστι καὶ ὠφελία τοῦ θεραπευομένου, ὥσπερ ὀρᾶς δὴ ὅτι οἱ ἵπποι ὑπὸ τῆς ἵππικῆς θεραπευόμενοι ὠφελοῦνται καὶ βελτίους γίνονται· ἢ οὐ δοκοῦσί σοι; ΕΥΘ. ἔμοιγε. ΣΩ. καὶ οἱ κύνες γέ που ὑπὸ τῆς κυνηγετικῆς, καὶ οἱ

13c

S: And dogs are, presumably, benefited by dog-handling, oxen by ox-herding, and the same applies in all other cases. Or do you think that the care aims to harm whatever it cares for?

13c

E: By Zeus, I do not.

13c

S: Does it aim to benefit it then?

13c

E: How could it do otherwise?

13c

S: Now, is holiness too, being a care of the gods, also a benefit to the gods, and does it make the gods better? And would you accept that you make any of the gods better whenever you do anything holy?

13c

E: By Zeus, I would not.

βόες ὑπὸ τῆς βοηλατικῆς, καὶ τᾶλλα πάντα ὡσαύτως· ἢ ἐπὶ βλάβῃ οἶει τοῦ θεραπευομένου τὴν θεραπείαν εἶναι; ΕΥΘ. μὰ Δί' οὐκ ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' ἐπ' ὠφελίᾳ; ΕΥΘ. πῶς δ' οὔ; ΣΩ. ἢ οὖν καὶ ἡ ὁσιότης θεραπεία οὔσα θεῶν ὠφελία τέ ἐστι θεῶν καὶ βελτίους τοὺς θεοὺς ποιεῖ; καὶ σὺ τοῦτο συγχωρήσας ἄν, ὡς ἐπειδάν τι ὅσιον ποιῇς, βελτίω τινὰ τῶν θεῶν ἀπεργάζῃ; ΕΥΘ. μὰ Δί' οὐκ ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. οὐδὲ γὰρ ἐγώ, ὦ Εὐθύφρων, οἶμαι σε τοῦτο λέγειν —πολλοῦ καὶ δέω—ἀλλὰ τούτου δὴ ἔνεκα καὶ ἀνηρόμην

13d

S: No, I did not think that was what you meant either, Euthyphro, far from it. And that is why I asked you what exactly you meant by this care of the gods. I was assuming you did not mean anything like this.

13d

E: And you are right, Socrates. I do not mean anything like this.

13d

S: So be it. But in that case, what care of the gods would holiness be?

13d

E: It is the care, Socrates, which servants give their masters.

13d

S: I understand. It would, it seems, be some service to the gods.

13d

E: Yes, certainly.

13d

S: What about the service to physicians? What product does this service help to produce? Do you not think it is health?

13d

E: I do.

τίνα ποτὲ λέγοις τὴν θεραπείαν τῶν θεῶν, οὐχ ἡγούμενός σε τοιαύτην λέγειν. ΕΥΘ. καὶ ὀρθῶς γε, ὦ Σώκρατες· οὐ γὰρ τοιαύτην λέγω. ΣΩ. εἶεν· ἀλλὰ τίς δὴ θεῶν θεραπεία εἴη ἂν ἡ ὁσιότης; ΕΥΘ. ἦνπερ, ὦ Σώκρατες, οἱ δοῦλοι τοὺς δεσπότας θεραπεύουσιν. ΣΩ. μανθάνω· ὑπηρετική τις ἂν, ὥς ἔοικεν, εἴη θεοῖς. ΕΥΘ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. ἔχοις ἂν οὖν εἰπεῖν ἡ ἱατροῖς ὑπηρετική εἰς τίνος ἔργου ἀπεργασίαν τυγχάνει οὕσα ὑπηρετική; οὐκ εἰς ὑγείας οἶει; ΕΥΘ. ἔγωγε.

13e

S: What about service to shipbuilders? What product does this service help to produce?

ΣΩ. τί δὲ ἡ ναυπηγοῖς ὑπηρετική; εἰς τίνος ἔργου ἀπεργασίαν ὑπηρετική ἐστιν; ΕΥΘ. δῆλον ὅτι, ὦ Σώκρατες, εἰς πλοίου. ΣΩ. καὶ ἡ οἰκοδόμοις γέ που εἰς οἰκίας; ΕΥΘ. ναί. ΣΩ. εἰπὲ δὴ, ὦ ἄριστε· ἡ δὲ θεοῖς ὑπηρετική εἰς τίνος ἔργου ἀπεργασίαν ὑπηρετική ἂν εἴη; δῆλον γὰρ ὅτι σὺ οἶσθα, ἐπειδὴ περ τά γε θεῖα κάλλιστα φῆς εἰδέναι ἀνθρώπων. ΕΥΘ. καὶ ἀληθῆ γε λέγω, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. εἰπὲ δὴ πρὸς Διὸς τί ποτὲ ἐστὶν ἐκεῖνο τὸ πάγκαλον ἔργον ὃ οἱ θεοὶ ἀπεργάζονται ἡμῖν ὑπηρεταῖς χρώμενοι; ΕΥΘ. πολλὰ καὶ καλὰ, ὦ Σώκρατες.

14a

E: Obviously, Socrates, it is a ship.

14a

S: And in the case of housebuilders, presumably it is a house?

14a

E: Yes.

14a

S: Then tell me, best of men, in the case of service to the gods, what product would this service help to produce? You must know the answer since you declare that your knowledge of matters divine is superior to that of anyone else.

14a

E: And what I say is true, Socrates.

14a

S: Then tell me, by Zeus, what glorious product do the gods produce, using us as their servants?

14a

E: Many and beautiful things, Socrates.

14a

S: Yes, so do the generals, my friend, but it is easy nevertheless to sum it all up by saying that they bring about victory in war. Isn't this so?

14a

E: Of course.

14a

S: And farmers too produce many and beautiful things, but nevertheless what they produce is, in summary, food from the earth.

14a

E: Certainly.

14a

S: Yes, but what about the many beautiful things that the gods produce? What, in summary, is their product?

ΣΩ. καὶ γὰρ οἱ στρατηγοί, ὧ φίλε· ἀλλ' ὅμως τὸ κεφάλαιον αὐτῶν ῥαδίως ἂν εἴποις, ὅτι νίκην ἐν τῷ πολέμῳ ἀπεργάζονται· ἢ οὐ; γ ΕΥΘ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΣΩ. πολλὰ δέ γ', οἶμαι, καὶ καλὰ καὶ οἱ γεωργοί· ἀλλ' ὅμως τὸ κεφάλαιον αὐτῶν ἐστὶν τῆς ἀπεργασίας ἡ ἐκ τῆς γῆς τροφή. ΕΥΘ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. τί δὲ δὴ τῶν πολλῶν καὶ καλῶν ἃ οἱ θεοὶ ἀπεργάζονται; τί τὸ κεφάλαιόν ἐστι τῆς ἐργασίας; ΕΥΘ. καὶ ὀλίγον σοι πρότερον εἶπον, ὧ Σώκρατες, ὅτι

14b

E: Well, I told you a little earlier, Socrates, that to understand precisely how matters stand in all these cases is a major undertaking. Yet I can say, in general terms, that if someone knows how to do and say what is gratifying to the gods, by praying and offering sacrifices, these actions are the holy ones, and such actions safeguard the things of private homes and the common things of entire cities. But the opposite of

what gratifies them is impious, and this overturns and destroys everything.

πλείονος ἔργου ἐστὶν ἀκριβῶς πάντα ταῦτα ὡς ἔχει μαθεῖν· τόδε μέντοι σοι ἀπλῶς λέγω, ὅτι ἐὰν μὲν κεχαρισμένα τις ἐπίστηται τοῖς θεοῖς λέγειν τε καὶ πράττειν εὐχόμενός τε καὶ θύων, ταῦτ' ἔστι τὰ ὅσια, καὶ σφύζει τὰ τοιαῦτα τοὺς τε ἰδίους οἴκους καὶ τὰ κοινὰ τῶν πόλεων· τὰ δ' ἐναντία τῶν κεχαρισμένων ἀσεβῆ, ἃ δὴ καὶ ἀνατρέπει ἅπαντα καὶ ἀπόλλυσιν. ΣΩ. ἦ πολὺ μοι διὰ βραχυτέρων, ὦ Εὐθύφρων, εἰ ἐβούλου, εἶπες ἂν τὸ κεφάλαιον ὧν ἡρώτων· ἀλλὰ γὰρ οὐ

14c

S: If you had wanted to, Euthyphro, you could have given me the summary I asked you for much more briefly. But you are not eager to instruct me, that is obvious. In fact, right now you turned aside at the very point where, had you answered, I might by now have learned about holiness from you quite adequately. But now the lover needs to follow the beloved, wherever he may lead. So again, what do you say the holy and holiness is? Is it not some sort of knowledge of sacrificing and praying?

14c

E: It is.

14c

S: Is not sacrifice giving to the gods, and prayer asking of the gods?

14c

E: Very much so, Socrates.

πρόθυμός με εἶ διδάξαι—δῆλος εἶ. καὶ γὰρ νῦν ἐπειδὴ ἐπ' αὐτῷ ἦσθα ἀπετράπου, ὃ εἰ ἀπεκρίνω, ἱκανῶς ἂν ἤδη παρὰ σοῦ τὴν ὁσιότητα ἐμεμαθήκη. νῦν δὲ ἀνάγκη γὰρ τὸν ἐρῶντα τῷ ἐρωμένῳ ἀκολουθεῖν ὅπῃ ἂν ἐκεῖνος ὑπάγῃ, τί δὴ αὖ λέγεις τὸ ὅσιον εἶναι καὶ τὴν ὁσιότητα; οὐχὶ ἐπιστήμην τινὰ τοῦ θύειν τε καὶ εὔχεσθαι; ΕΥΘ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τὸ θύειν δωρεῖσθαι ἐστὶ τοῖς θεοῖς, τὸ δ' εὔχεσθαι αἰτεῖν τοὺς θεούς; ΕΥΘ. καὶ μάλα, ὦ Σώκρατες.

14d

S: So on this formulation, holiness would be knowledge of asking of and giving to the gods.

14d

E: You have understood perfectly what I have said, Socrates.

14d

S: That is because I am eager for your wisdom, my friend, and I give it my full attention so that nothing you say may be lost. But tell me, what is this service to the gods? Are you saying that it consists in asking of them and giving to them?

14d

E: I am.

14d

S: And would not the right manner of asking be to ask of them what we need from them?

14d

E: That is it.

ΣΩ. ἐπιστήμη ἄρα αἰτήσεως καὶ δόσεως θεοῖς ὁσιότης ἂν εἴη ἐκ τούτου τοῦ λόγου. ΕΥΘ. πάνυ καλῶς, ὦ Σώκρατες, συνῆκας ὃ εἶπον. ΣΩ. ἐπιθυμητῆς γάρ εἰμι, ὦ φίλε, τῆς σῆς σοφίας καὶ προσέχω τὸν νοῦν αὐτῇ, ὥστε οὐ χαμαὶ πεσεῖται ὅτι ἂν εἴπης. ἀλλὰ μοι λέξον τίς αὕτη ἡ ὑπηρεσία ἐστὶ τοῖς θεοῖς; αἰτεῖν τε φῆς αὐτοὺς καὶ διδόναι ἐκείνοις; ΕΥΘ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν οὐ τό γε ὀρθῶς αἰτεῖν ἂν εἴη ὧν δεόμεθα παρ' ἐκείνων, ταῦτα αὐτοὺς αἰτεῖν; ΕΥΘ. ἀλλὰ τί;

14e

S: Then again, is not the right manner of giving to give them in return whatever they happen to need from us? Indeed, giving anyone something they do not need would, presumably, not require any skill.

14e

E: That is true, Socrates.

14e

S: Then, Euthyphro, holiness would be a skill which involved gods and men trading with one another.

14e

E: Yes, call it trade if it pleases you to do so.

ΣΩ. καὶ αὖ τὸ διδόναι ὀρθῶς, ὧν ἐκεῖνοι τυγχάνουσιν δεόμενοι παρ' ἡμῶν, ταῦτα ἐκείνοις αὖ ἀντιδωρεῖσθαι; οὐ γάρ που τεχνικόν γ' ἂν εἴη δωροφορεῖν διδόντα τῷ ταῦτα ὧν οὐδὲν δεῖται. ΕΥΘ. ἀληθῆ λέγεις, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. ἐμπορικὴ ἄρα τις ἂν εἴη, ὧς Εὐθύφρων, τέχνη ἡ ὁσιότης θεοῖς καὶ ἀνθρώποις παρ' ἀλλήλων. ΕΥΘ. ἐμπορικὴ, εἰ οὕτως ἥδιόν σοι ὀνομάζειν. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' οὐδὲν ἥδιον ἔμοιγε, εἰ μὴ τυγχάνει ἀληθὲς ὄν. φράσον δέ μοι, τίς ἡ ὠφελία τοῖς θεοῖς τυγχάνει οὔσα ἀπὸ τῶν δώρων ὧν παρ' ἡμῶν λαμβάνουσιν; ἃ μὲν γὰρ διδόασι

15a

S: Well, nothing pleases me unless it happens to be true. But tell me, what benefit do the gods derive from the gifts they obtain from us? What they give us is obvious to everyone, for anything good that we have, they have given us. But how are they benefited by what they obtain from us? Or do we gain such an advantage over them from the trading that we get all good things from them, while they get nothing from us?

15a

E: But Socrates, do you think the gods derive benefit from what they obtain from us?

15a

S: But Euthyphro, what exactly would these gifts we bestow upon the gods be?

15a

E: What else do you think, except honour, reverence and, as I said earlier, gratification.

παντὶ δῆλον· οὐδὲν γὰρ ἡμῖν ἐστὶν ἀγαθὸν ὅτι ἂν μὴ ἐκεῖνοι δῶσιν. ἃ δὲ παρ' ἡμῶν λαμβάνουσιν, τί ὠφελοῦνται; ἢ τοσοῦτον αὐτῶν πλεονεκτοῦμεν κατὰ τὴν ἐμπορίαν, ὥστε πάντα τὰ ἀγαθὰ παρ' αὐτῶν λαμβάνομεν, ἐκεῖνοι δὲ παρ' ἡμῶν οὐδέν; ΕΥΘ. ἀλλ' οἶει, ὦ Σώκρατες, τοὺς θεοὺς ὠφελεῖσθαι ἀπὸ τούτων ἃ παρ' ἡμῶν λαμβάνουσιν; γ ΣΩ.

ἀλλὰ τί δήποτ' ἂν εἴη ταῦτα, ὦ Εὐθύφρων, τὰ παρ' ἡμῶν δῶρα τοῖς θεοῖς; ΕΥΘ. τί δ' οἶει ἄλλο ἢ τιμή τε καὶ γέρα καί, ὅπερ ἐγὼ ἄρτι ἔλεγον, χάρις;

15b

S: So, the holy is gratifying to the gods, Euthyphro, but is it not beneficial to them, or loved by them?

15b

E: I really think it is the most beloved thing of all.

15b

S: So once again it seems that the holy is what is loved by the gods.

15b

E: Very much so.

15b

S: And once you say this, will you be surprised then to find that our propositions are inconstant and go walking? And will you accuse me of being the Daedalus who makes them walk, when you yourself are far more skilled than Daedalus, and can make them go around in a circle? Or can you not see that our argument has gone around in a circle and arrived back in the same place? For I presume you remember that, in our previous discussion, it was evident to us that what is holy and what is god-loved are not the same, but differ from one another. Or do you not remember?

ΣΩ. κεχαρισμένον ἄρα ἐστίν, ὦ Εὐθύφρων, τὸ ὅσιον, ἀλλ' οὐχὶ ὠφέλιμον οὐδὲ φίλον τοῖς θεοῖς; γ ΕΥΘ. οἶμαι ἔγωγε πάντων γε μάλιστα φίλον. ΣΩ. τοῦτο ἄρ' ἐστὶν αὖ, ὥς ἔοικε, τὸ ὅσιον, τὸ τοῖς θεοῖς φίλον. ΕΥΘ. μάλιστα γε. ΣΩ. θαυμάσῃ οὖν ταῦτα λέγων ἐάν σοι οἱ λόγοι φαίνωνται μὴ μένοντες ἀλλὰ βαδίζοντες, καὶ ἐμὲ αἰτιάσῃ τὸν Δαίδαλον βαδίζοντας αὐτοὺς ποιεῖν, αὐτὸς ὢν πολὺ γε τεχνικώτερος τοῦ Δαίδαλου καὶ κύκλῳ περιόντα ποιῶν; ἢ οὐκ αἰσθάνῃ ὅτι ὁ λόγος ἡμῖν περιελθὼν πάλιν εἰς ταῦτόν

15c

E: I do.

15c

S: Well, do you not realise now that you are saying that what is loved by the gods is holy? But this happens not to be god-loved, does it not?

15c

E: Certainly.

15c

S: In that case, either our earlier agreement was incorrect or, if we were right then, we are wrong now.

15c

E: So it seems.

ἥκει; μέμνησαι γάρ που ὅτι ἐν τῷ πρόσθεν τό τε ὅσιον καὶ τὸ θεοφιλὲς οὐ ταὐτὸν ἡμῖν ἐφάνη ἀλλ' ἕτερα ἀλλήλων· ἢ οὐ μέμνησαι; ΕΥΘ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. νῦν οὖν οὐκ ἐννοεῖς ὅτι τὸ τοῖς θεοῖς φίλον φησὶ ὅσιον εἶναι; τοῦτο δ' ἄλλο τι ἢ θεοφιλὲς γίγνεται; ἢ οὔ; ΕΥΘ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἢ ἄρτι οὐ καλῶς ὠμολογοῦμεν, ἢ εἰ τότε καλῶς, νῦν οὐκ ὀρθῶς τιθέμεθα. ΕΥΘ. ἔοικεν. ΣΩ. ἐξ ἀρχῆς ἄρα ἡμῖν πάλιν σκεπτέον τί ἐστὶ τὸ ὅσιον, ὥς ἐγὼ πρὶν ἂν μάθω ἐκὼν εἶναι οὐκ ἀποδειλιάσω.

15d

S: Then, we must consider what holiness is once more from the beginning, since I am not willing to give up until I have learned this. But please, do not be contemptuous towards me. Just give this your fullest attention in every way, and tell me the truth now. For you know the truth if any man knows it, and, just like Proteus,⁸ you are not to be let go until you tell me. For if you did not know full well what is holy and also what is unholy, there is no possibility that you would ever have undertaken to prosecute an old man, your own father, for murder, on behalf of a day-labourer. No, you would have feared the gods too much to take the risk that you might be acting improperly. And you would have been ashamed before your fellow men too. But I am now quite aware that you think you know full well what is holy and what is not. So tell me, excellent Euthyphro, and please do not hide what you think it is.

ἀλλὰ μή με ἀτιμάσης ἀλλὰ παντὶ τρόπῳ προσσχὼν τὸν νοῦν ὅτι μάλιστα νῦν εἰπὲ τὴν ἀλήθειαν· οἴσθα γὰρ εἶπερ τις ἄλλος ἀνθρώπων, καὶ οὐκ ἀφετέος εἶ ὥσπερ ὁ Πρωτεύς πρὶν ἂν εἴπῃς. εἰ γὰρ μὴ ἤδησθα σαφῶς τό τε ὅσιον καὶ τὸ ἀνόσιον, οὐκ ἔστιν ὅπως ἂν ποτε ἐπεχείρησας ὑπὲρ ἀνδρὸς θητὸς ἄνδρα πρεσβύτην πατέρα διωκᾶθαι φόνου, ἀλλὰ καὶ τοὺς θεοὺς ἂν ἔδεισας παρακινδυνεύειν μὴ οὐκ ὀρθῶς αὐτὸ ποιήσεις, καὶ τοὺς ἀνθρώπους ἡσχύνῃς· νῦν δὲ εὖ οἶδα ὅτι

15e

E: Well, some other time, Socrates, for I am rushing somewhere else now and it is time for me to go.

σαφῶς οἶμαι εἰδέναι τό τε ὅσιον καὶ μή. εἰπὲ οὖν, ὦ βέλτιστε Εὐθύφρων, καὶ μὴ ἀποκρύψῃ ὅτι αὐτὸ ἡγῇ. ΕΥΘ. εἰς αὐθις τοίνυν, ὦ Σώκρατες· νῦν γὰρ σπεύδω ποι, καὶ μοι ὥρα ἀπιέναι. ΣΩ. οἷα ποιεῖς, ὦ ἑταῖρε. ἀπ' ἐλπίδος με καταβαλὼν μεγάλης ἀπέρχῃ ἣν εἶχον, ὥς παρὰ σοῦ μαθὼν τά τε ὅσια καὶ μὴ καὶ τῆς πρὸς Μέλητον γραφῆς ἀπαλλάξομαι, ἐνδειξάμενος

16a

S: What are you doing my friend? You are leaving, casting me down from the great hope I had that, having learned what is holy and what is not from you, I would escape the charge of Meletus by showing him that, through Euthyphro, I had now become wise in divine matters, and that I no longer make rash pronouncements and innovations about them because of my ignorance, and that I would live a better life in all other respects from now on.

ἐκεῖνῳ ὅτι σοφὸς ἤδη παρ' Εὐθύφρονος τὰ θεῖα γέγονα καὶ ὅτι οὐκέτι ὑπ' ἀγνοίας αὐτοσχεδιάζω οὐδὲ καινοτομῶ περὶ αὐτά, καὶ δὴ καὶ τὸν ἄλλον βίον ὅτι ἄμεινον βιωσοίμην.

Notes

¹ The Lyceum was a temple in Athens dedicated to Apollo Lyceus, which later became a site for public exercise. It is perhaps best known as the location of

Aristotle's Peripatetic school, founded in 344.

² The Royal Stoa, an administrative building located in the Athenian Agora, was where Socrates was formally sent forward for trial.

³ Demes were small administrative areas within the city-state of Athens.

⁴ Daedalus, a figure in Greek mythology, was a skilled architect and craftsman. He was said to have sculpted figures so real that they appeared to live and move. Socrates' father was a sculptor, hence his claim to a familial connection.

⁵ Tantalus is best known for his punishment in the underworld. His wealth derived from mines in Phrygia.

⁶ These lines are of unknown authorship.

⁷ Plato is construing the concepts of odd number and even number here in terms of certain types of triangles: the scalene triangle, which has unequal sides, is odd, and the isosceles triangle, which has equal sides, is even.

⁸ *Odyssey* iv.382 ff.